electrotechnical certification scheme

HEALTH, SAFETY AND ENVIRONMENTAL ASSESSMENT

Revision Guide

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Revision Guide

For assessments from 6 May 2024

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The Electrotechnical JIB
Setting employment standards

Administered in England, Wales and Northern Ireland by the Joint Industry Board for the Electrotechnical Industry

SCOTTISH JIB

Administered in Scotland by the Scottish Joint Industry Board for the Electrical Contracting Industry

INTRODUCTION

The information in this guide is for ECS Health, Safety and Environmental Awareness Assessments taken from 6 May 2024.

The electrotechnical industry is constantly striving to improve the Health and Safety awareness of everyone working in the industry. The Electrotechnical Certification Scheme (ECS) Health, Safety and Environmental Awareness Assessment was originally introduced in 2002 in compliance of the Electrotechnical Certification Scheme's affiliation to the Construction Skills Certification Scheme (CSCS) that requires anyone obtaining or renewing an ECS Card to demonstrate an acceptable standard of health and safety knowledge.

THE ASSESSMENT

The ECS Health. Safety and Environmental Awareness Assessment is made up of 50 multiple choice questions drawn randomly from the question bank to be completed in 30 minutes. Each question will require one correct answer to be picked from a choice of four.

The assessment will be made up from questions covering eleven topics. The numbers of questions that will be used from each topic are:

General Health and Safety at Work	6
Manual Handling Operations	4
Reporting Accidents	3
Personal Protective Equipment at Work	4
Health and Hygiene	3
Fire and Emergency	9
Work at Height	5
Work Equipment	4
Special Site Hazards	3
Electrotechnical	6
Environmental	

To successfully pass an assessment, 43 out of the 50 questions must be answered correctly.

If the delegate is unsuccessful they may take a new assessment. A fee is chargeable by the assessment organisation for each assessment taken by the delegate.

PREPARATION

This guide should be used to help prepare for the assessment. The guide contains all the questions that can be used to make up the awareness assessment, together with the correct answer and, where applicable, a brief explanation of the answer. The assessment uses a selection of the questions from the question bank printed in this guide, however, the four answers in the assessment may be in a different order from the order shown in this guide. There are no questions in the assessment that are not in this guide. The assessment is designed to test basic knowledge and awareness of health and safety for people working in the electrical industry and on construction sites. The awareness assessment is not trying to trip up or catch people out. all the questions in the assessment are listed in this guide. The ECS Health Safety and Environmental Awareness Assessment may be used as the end of course test for health and safety training but in no way should be considered a qualification in Health and Safety.

ENGLAND, WALES AND NORTHERN IRELAND

The ECS HSE Awareness Assessment is available online through the MyECS and Employer Portal and this remote invigilation system is the quickest and simplest way to do the assessment.

For those who wish to attend a physical centre for assessments, please see the ECS website at www.ecscard.org.uk/venues

SCOTLAND

The SJIB offers paper-based assessments across the whole of Scotland. Please call 0131 445 9216 to book an assessment or visit www.sjib.org.uk for more information.

ONLINE ASSESSMENTS

For remotely invigilated assessments taken at home or at work, there is a guidance video on the ECS website which shows how to set up and take assessments. This can be found at www.ecscard.org.uk/RIS

System Requirements

- To be in a room on your own and not be disturbed
- Have a current photo ID with you
- Have a stable Internet connection and working web cam

IN CENTRE ASSESSMENTS

The delegate will need:

- Photographic identification such as an ECS card, current passport or in date photo driving license
- National Insurance Number
- A valid personal email address (for the result to be sent to if taking the computer-based version of the assessment).

An invigilator will explain how to take the assessment, will check the delegate' s identity and take the delegate's photograph as a record of the person who took the assessment.

For delegates that are not confident in using computer equipment, a practice test is available before the main assessment is taken. To take the practice assessment the delegate must request it from the session invigilator prior to taking the main assessment. There is no charge for the practice assessment.

The invigilator will be on hand during the assessment to provide administrative support but will not offer any assistance with answering the assessment questions.

If a computer-based assessment is taken the delegate will be informed of their result at the end of the assessment. The delegate will also be able to review the answers to the questions that were in their assessment.

Listed below are the areas of knowledge that will be assessed.

1. General Health & Safety

You should have a basic understanding of:

- How the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974, Regulations and Approved Codes of Practice affect you
- Employer's responsibilities under the Health and Safety at Work Act
- Your responsibilities to yourself and to others under the Health and Safety at Work Act
- How health and safety law is enforced
- The powers of Health and Safety Executive (HSE) inspectors
- The key features of health and safety signs in the workplace

2. Manual Handling Operations

You should have a basic understanding of:

- What manual handling operations mean in the context of an employee and what employers must do to protect employees from injury
- The types of injury you could suffer from carrying out manual handling tasks
- The parts of your body most likely to be affected by manual handling injuries
- How to decide whether a manual handling activity is safe
- What must be taken into account when making a manual handling risk assessment
- The principles of good manual handling techniques

3. Reporting Accidents

You should have a basic understanding of:

- The need to report injuries, accidents, certain diseases and dangerous occurrences to the Health and Safety Executive
- Why you must report accidents to your employer
- The need to record in the accident book all accidents that cause any injury whatsoever
- What reportable injuries, dangerous occurrences and reportable diseases are

4. Personal Protective Equipment at Work

You should have a basic understanding of:

- When PPE should be worn
- Why your employer must provide you with PPE
- Why you must use the PPE provided by the employer
- Why you must take care of PPE supplied for your use
- Why you must report lost or damaged PPE to your immediate superior
- The possible effects of not wearing PPE
- The limitations of PPE

5. Health and Hygiene

You should have a basic understanding of:

- The dangers of exposure to substances, such as asbestos
- The importance of good personal hygiene when working with hazardous substances
- How to reduce the risks of diseases carried by vermin
- The welfare facilities required to be provided on construction sites.
- How to reduce the risks from hand-arm vibration and noise at work

6. Fire and Emergency

You should have a basic understanding of:

- What to do in the event of an emergency at work
- The types of fire extinguishers available and the types of fires they can each be used on
- The importance of first aid following an accident
- Basic knowledge of fire safety in buildings including fire stopping and the role of the Building Safety Regulator

7. Work at Height

You should have a basic understanding of:

- The importance of using the most suitable access equipment for the task
- Only working from ladders or stepladders when the task is of low risk and short duration
- Safety precautions to be taken when using scaffolds, mobile elevated work platforms, safety harnesses etc.

8. Work Equipment

You should have a basic understanding of:

- Only using work equipment you have been trained and authorised to use
- The importance of carrying out checks on equipment before use
- Reporting any defects and not using defective equipment
- The use of reduced low voltage systems to supply hand-held electrical equipment on construction sites
- The safe use of extension cables

9. Special Site Hazards

You should have a basic understanding of:

- The safety precautions to be taken before working in a confined space
- The precautions to be taken when carrying out excavation work to reduce the risks from contact with underground services, falling materials etc.
- The precautions to be taken when working near overhead power lines
- The dangers to pedestrians from vehicles on site
- The additional risks to young people at work and those working alone

10. Electrotechnical

You should have an understanding of:

- The effects of electric current on the body
- The types of socket outlets used on construction sites
- The need for persons working on electrical systems to be competent to do so
- The use of residual current devices for additional protection against electric shock
- Safe isolation procedures when working on electrical systems and equipment
- Only working 'live' in exceptional circumstances
- Safe working with optical fibres

11. Environmental

You should have an understanding of:

- The responsibilities and requirements for handling materials
- Actions for recycling and to minimise waste
- The identification of hazardous/special waste
- The precautions and procedures for handling hazardous/special waste
- Sustainability in the selection and use of materials

GENERAL HEALTH AND SAFETY AT WORK

QUESTION 1.1

What do the letters CDM stand for?

A.	Control of Demolition and Management Regulations	**Right Answer: D** The CDM Regulations impose duties to manage construction projects, ensure physical safeguards are provided to prevent danger during such projects and that adequate welfare facilities are provided.
B.	Control of Dangerous Materials Regulations	
C.	Construction (Demolition Management) Regulations	
D.	Construction (Design and Management) Regulations	

QUESTION 1.2

Identify one method of enforcing regulations that are available to the Health and Safety Executive:

A.	Health Notice	**Right Answer: B** Improvement notices require action to achieve standards which meet health and safety law.
B.	Improvement Notice	
C	Obstruction Notice	
D.	Increasing insurance premiums	

QUESTION 1.3

What happens if a Prohibition Notice is issued by an Inspector of the local authority or the HSE?

A.	The work in hand can be completed, but no new work started	**Right Answer: C** The work activity covered by a prohibition notice must cease, until the identified danger is removed.
B.	The work can continue if adequate safety precautions are put in place	
C.	The work that is subject to the notice must cease	
D.	The work can continue, provided a risk assessment is carried out	

QUESTION 1.4

Health and Safety Executive Inspector can?

A.	Only visit if they have made an appointment	**Right Answer: B** Inspectors have a range of powers, including the right to visit premises at any time.
B.	Visit at any time	
C.	Only visit if accompanied by the principal contractor	
D.	Only visit to interview the site manager	

QUESTION 1.5

Prohibition Notice means:

A.	When you finish the work you must not start again	**Right Answer: B** The work activity covered by the prohibition notice must cease, until the identified danger is removed.
B.	The work must stop immediately	
C.	Work is to stop for that day only	
D.	Work may continue until the end of the day	

QUESTION 1.6

In what circumstances can an HSE Improvement Notice be issued?

A.	If there is a breach of legal requirements	**Right Answer: A** Improvement notices require action to achieve standards which meet health and safety law.
B.	By warrant through the police	
C.	Only between Monday and Friday on site	
D.	Through the prosecution office	

QUESTION 1.7		
What is an Improvement Notice?		
A.	A notice issued by the site principal contractor to tidy up the site	**Right Answer: D** Improvement notices require action to achieve standards which meet health and safety law.
B.	A notice from the client to the principal contractor to speed up the work	
C.	A notice issued by a Building Control Officer to deepen foundations	
D.	A notice issued by an HSE/local authority Inspector to enforce compliance with health and safety legislation	

QUESTION 1.8		
If a Health and Safety Executive Inspector issues a Prohibition Notice, this means that:		
A.	The Site Manager can choose whether or not to ignore the notice	**Right Answer: B** Prohibition notices are intended to stop activities which can cause serious injury.
B.	Specific work activities, highlighted on the notice, must stop	
C.	The HSE must supervise the work covered by the notice	
D.	The HSE must supervise all work from then on	

QUESTION 1.9		
Employers are required to provide information to their employees on their health and safety rights and responsibilities and how to get advice by:		
A.	Telling them verbally when they start work for them	**Right Answer: B** This is a requirement of the Health and Safety Information for Employees Regulations (as amended).
B.	Displaying a poster or giving them leaflets approved by the HSE	
C.	Making them read the company health and safety policy	
D.	E-mailing the information to them	

QUESTION 1.10		
Who is responsible for signing a Company Safety Policy?		
A.	Site Manager	**Right Answer: D** The Health and Safety at Work Act requires the most senior member of management to sign the health and safety policy statement.
B.	Company Safety Officer	
C.	Company Secretary	
D.	Managing Director	

QUESTION 1.11		
Which one of the following must be in a company's written Health and Safety Policy?		
A.	Aims and objectives of the company	**Right Answer: B** This is a specific requirement of the Health and Safety at Work Act.
B.	Organisation and arrangements in force for carrying out the health and safety policy	
C.	Name of the Health and Safety Adviser	
D.	Company Director's home address	

QUESTION 1.12		
Employers have to produce a written Health and Safety Policy statement when:		
A.	A contract commences	**Right Answer: B** This is a specific requirement of the Health and Safety at Work Act.
B.	They employ five people or more	
C.	The safety representative requests it	
D.	The HSE notifies them	

QUESTION 1.13		
Companies employing five or more people must have a written Health and Safety Policy because:		
A.	The principal contractor gives them work on site	**Right Answer: B**
B.	The HSAWA 1974 requires it	
C.	The Social Security Act requires it	
D.	The trade unions require it	

QUESTION 1.14		
What do the letters HSE stand for?		
A.	Highly Safe Electrician	**Right Answer: D** The Health and Safety Executive was established under the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974.
B.	Health and Safety Exercise	
C.	Health and Safety Examiner	
D.	Health and Safety Executive	

QUESTION 1.15		
The Health and Safety Executive is:		
A.	Part of the National Health Service	**Right Answer: B** The Health and Safety Executive is part of the Department for Work and Pensions.
B.	The regulatory body for the promotion of health and safety at work	
C.	The jury in health and safety court cases	
D.	Part of the police force	

QUESTION 1.16		
The Health and Safety at Work Act requires employers to provide what for their employees?		
A.	Adequate rest periods	**Right Answer: C** This is a specific requirement of Section 2 of the Health and Safety at Work Act.
B.	Payment for work done	
C.	A safe place of work	
D.	Suitable transport to work	

QUESTION 1.17		
The Health and Safety at Work Act 1974 and any regulations made under the Act are:		
A.	Not compulsory, but should be complied with if convenient	**Right Answer: D** The requirements of health and safety law are mandatory and failure to follow them can lead to prosecution.
B.	Advisory to companies and individuals	
C.	Practical advice for the employer to follow	
D.	Legally binding	

QUESTION 1.18		
Under the Health and Safety at Work Act 1974, which of the following have a duty to work safely?		
A.	Employees only	**Right Answer: D** Employers, employees and the self-employed all have duties to work safely under the Act.
B.	The general public	
C.	Employers only	
D.	All people at work	

QUESTION 1.19		
What is the MAXIMUM penalty that a Higher Court, can currently impose for a breach of the Health and Safety at Work Act?		
A.	£20,000 fine and two years' imprisonment	**Right Answer: D** A Lower Court can impose a fine of up to £20,000 and/or up to six months imprisonment for certain offences. The potential fine in a Higher Court, however, is unlimited and the term of imprisonment can be up to 2 years.
B.	£15,000 fine and three years' imprisonment	
C.	£1,000 fine and six months imprisonment	
D.	Unlimited fine and two years' imprisonment	

QUESTION 1.20		
What do the letters ACOP stand for?		
A.	Accepted Code of Provisions	**Right Answer: C** An ACOP is a code of practice approved by the Health and Safety Executive (or the Health and Safety Commission prior to April 2008).
B.	Approved Condition of Practice	
C.	Approved Code of Practice	
D.	Accepted Code of Practice	

QUESTION 1.21		
Where should you look for official advice on health and safety matters?		
A.	A set of health and safety guidelines provided by suppliers	**Right Answer: C** The HSE is the UK enforcing body and its guidance can be regarded as 'official'.
B.	The health and safety rules as laid down by the employer	
C.	Guidance issued by the Health and Safety Executive	
D.	A professionally approved guide book on regulations	

QUESTION 1.22		
Regulations that govern health and safety on construction sites:		
A.	Apply only to inexperienced workers	**Right Answer: D** The requirements of health and safety law are mandatory, and failure to follow them can lead to prosecutions.
B.	Do not apply during 'out of hours' working	
C.	Apply only to large companies	
D.	Are mandatory (that is, compulsory)	

QUESTION 1.23		
Which of the following statements is correct?		
A.	The duty for health and safety falls only on the employer	**Right Answer: B** This is a legal requirement under Section 7 of the Health & Safety at Work Act.
B.	All employees must take reasonable care, not only to protect themselves but also their colleagues	
C.	Employees have no responsibility for Health and Safety on site	
D.	Only the client is responsible for safety on site	

QUESTION 1.24		
Who of the following would you expect to be responsible for managing health and safety on site?		
A.	Foreman	**Right Answer: B** The responsibility for management of health and safety at work rests with the employer.
B.	Your employer	
C.	Main sub-contractor	
D.	HSE Inspector	

QUESTION 1.25		
Which of the following is correct for risk assessment?		
A.	It is a good idea but not essential	**Right Answer: C** There is a legal requirement for all work to be suitably risk assessed.
B.	Only required to be done for hazardous work	
C.	Must always be done	
D.	Only required on major jobs	

QUESTION 1.26		
In the context of a risk assessment, what do you understand by the term risk?		
A.	An unsafe act or condition	**Right Answer: D** Hazard and risk are not the same. Risk reflects the chance of being harmed by a hazard.
B.	Something with the potential to cause injury	
C.	Any work activity that can be described as dangerous	
D.	The likelihood that harm from a particular hazard will occur	

QUESTION 1.27		
Who would you expect to carry out a risk assessment on your working site?		
A.	The CDM Co-ordinator	**Right Answer: D** A risk assessment must be conducted by a 'competent person'.
B.	A visiting HSE Inspector	
C.	The construction project designer	
D.	A competent person	

QUESTION 1.28		
What is a HAZARD?		
A.	Where an accident is likely to happen	**Right Answer: C** Examples of hazards include: a drum of acid, breeze blocks on an elevated plank; cables running across a floor.
B.	An accident waiting to happen	
C.	Something with the potential to cause harm	
D.	The likelihood of something going wrong	

QUESTION 1.29		
What must be done before any work begins?		
A.	Emergency plan	**Right Answer: B** This is a legal requirement of the Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations.
B.	Assessment of risk	
C.	Soil assessment	
D.	Geological survey	

QUESTION 1.30		
Complete the following sentence: A risk assessment:		
A.	Is a piece of paper required by law	**Right Answer: C** Risk assessment involves a careful review of what can cause harm and the practical measures to be taken to reduce the risk of harm.
B.	Prevents accidents	
C.	Is a means of analysing what might go wrong	
D.	Isn't particularly useful	

QUESTION 1.31		
Why would your supervisor ask you to read the method statement and risk assessment before you start your next job?		
A.	They think you have got nothing better to do	**Right Answer: B** The supervisor must, by law, keep workers advised of significant risks, and control measures.
B.	The documents contain information on how to carry out the job in a safe manner	
C.	They wouldn't as they think they are a waste of time	
D.	As someone has taken the time and trouble to write them, you might as well read them	

QUESTION 1.32		
What do the blue and white health and safety signs tell you?		
A.	Things you must do	**Right Answer: A** Blue and white signs show a 'mandatory' requirement.
B.	Where the nearest fire exit is	
C.	The hazards in the area	
D.	Things you must not do	

QUESTION 1.33		
What colours are emergency exit signs?		
A.	Green and white	**Right Answer: A** The colours are prescribed in the Health and Safety (Safety Signs and Signals) Regulations.
B.	Red and yellow	
C.	Red and white	
D.	Blue and white	

QUESTION 1.34		
What is the main colour on a safety sign stating that you must NOT do something?		
A.	Blue	**Right Answer: C** Prohibitory signs are round and feature a black pictogram on a white background with red edging and diagonal line.
B.	Green	
C.	Red	
D.	Yellow	

QUESTION 1.35		
The Health and Safety (Safety Signs and Signals) Regulations require the colour coding of signs. What colours are used on a sign indicating a warning, for example 'Fork-lift trucks operating'?		
A.	Blue and white	**Right Answer: C** Warning signs are triangular and feature a black pictogram on a yellow background with black edging.
B.	Green and white	
C.	Yellow and black	
D.	Red and white	

QUESTION 1.36		
The Health and Safety (Safety Signs and Signals) Regulations require the colour coding of safety signs. What colours are used on a sign indicating a prohibited activity, for example 'No access for pedestrians' ?		
A.	Green and white	**Right Answer: B** Prohibitory signs are round and feature a black pictogram on a white background with red edging and diagonal line.
B.	Red, black and white	
C.	Blue and white	
D.	Yellow and black	

QUESTION 1.37		
The Health and Safety (Safety Signs and Signals) Regulations require the colour coding of safety signs. What colours are used on a sign indicating a mandatory activity, for example 'Safety helmets must be worn'?		
A.	Green and white	**Right Answer: C** Mandatory signs are round and feature a white pictogram on a blue background.
B.	Red, black and white	
C.	Blue and white	
D.	Yellow and black	

QUESTION 1.38		
The Health and Safety (Safety Signs and Signals) Regulations require the colour coding of safety signs. What colours are used on a sign indicating a safe condition, for example First Aid kit?		
A.	Red, black and white	**Right Answer: D** Emergency escape and first-aid signs are rectangular or square and feature a white pictogram on a green background.
B.	Blue and white	
C.	Yellow and black	
D.	Green and white	

QUESTION 1.39		
Why should regular inspections of the workplace take place?		
A.	To check whether the working environment is safe	**Right Answer: A** The Management of Health and Safety at Work Regulations require that routine inspections of workplaces are carried out to ensure that preventative and protective measures are in place and effective.
B.	To check that all employees are present	
C.	To check that everyone is doing their job	
D.	To prepare for a visit from an HSE Inspector	

QUESTION 1.40		
How can you help to prevent accidents?		
A.	Don't report them	**Right Answer: C** Action to improve safety can only be taken if the risk is known about. Employees have a duty of care to other employees.
B.	Know how to get help quickly	
C.	Report any unsafe conditions	
D.	Know where the first-aid kit is kept	

MANUAL HANDLING OPERATIONS

QUESTION 2.1

If there is a risk of injury from lifting loads what should you think about first?

A.	Whether the load needs to be lifted at all	**Right Answer: A** If possible, it is best to avoid the risks from lifting altogether. This is the preferred requirement laid down in the Manual Handling Operations Regulations 1992.
B.	What the weight of the load is	
C.	Where to hold the load when lifting	
D.	How to lift the load	

QUESTION 2.2

Before performing manual lifting what is the first thing you should do?

A.	Check the headroom	**Right Answer: C** If you assess the whole task first, you will have a clear idea of possible hazards and how to overcome them, before lifting.
B.	Weigh the article	
C.	Assess the whole task	
D.	Kick it to see if it is stable	

QUESTION 2.3

Which is the part of your body MOST LIKELY to be injured during a manual handling activity which involves moving a heavy load?

A.	Knees	**Right Answer: D** HSE statistics show that most manual handling injuries are to the back.
B.	Forearms	
C.	Chest	
D.	Back	

QUESTION 2.4

What should you do if your supervisor asks you to move something that you find is too heavy to lift?

A.	Give it a try using correct lifting methods	**Right Answer: C** The HSE advises employees to inform the employer if they identify hazardous handling activities.
B.	Ask your mates to assist in the lift	
C.	Inform your supervisor that it is too heavy	
D.	Get a forklift truck or lifting tackle	

QUESTION 2.5

What would you NOT consider in making a judgement of the risks from a load?

A.	Its size and condition	**Right Answer: B** A, C and D can all affect the difficulty of lifting an object.
B.	Its colour	
C.	Its weight	
D.	Its centre of gravity	

QUESTION 2.6

When moving a load fitted with wheels which of the following is generally true?

A.	Pushing and pulling are equally risky	**Right Answer: C** The operator should try to push rather than pull when moving a load, provided they can see over it and control steering and stopping.
B.	Pulling is preferable to pushing	
C.	Pushing is preferable to pulling	
D.	It is safer to pick it up and carry it	

QUESTION 2.7		
A manual handling operation is defined as which one of the following?		
A.	Automated effort	**Right Answer: B** Manual handling covers human effort only.
B.	Human effort	
C.	Mechanised and human effort	
D.	Mechanised effort	

QUESTION 2.8		
What is the MAXIMUM weight that an individual may lift?		
A.	The weight they can lift comfortably	**Right Answer: A** There are no strict weight limits – the priority is to avoid injury.
B.	Whatever the supervisor instructs	
C.	35kg provided that it has no sharp edges	
D.	15kg provided that it is a compact load	

QUESTION 2.9		
What is the most common type of injury resulting from lifting loads from the floor?		
A.	Vibration white finger	**Right Answer: D** As shown by HSE statistics.
B.	Grazes to the knees	
C.	Head injuries	
D.	Back injuries	

QUESTION 2.10		
Where a load has to be lifted manually, what is the employer required to do by law?		
A.	Calculate the cost of the exercise	**Right Answer: C** This is a specific requirement of the Manual Handling Operations regulations 1992.
B.	Determine the number of people required	
C.	Assess the risk of the task	
D.	Assess the time the job will take	

QUESTION 2.11		
Which of the following is advisable when lifting a load manually?		
A.	Keep legs straight, bend back, use power of legs	**Right Answer: C** Stooping can increase the stress on the lower back. However, stooping slightly may be preferable to adopting a squatting posture, which can place excessive loads on knees and hips.
B.	Bend the knees, keep the back straight, use power of back	
C.	Bend the knees, keep the back as straight as possible, use power of legs	
D.	Keep legs and back straight, use power of legs	

QUESTION 2.12		
In manual handling, which of the following general statements is true?		
A.	You should keep your back bent when lifting	**Right Answer: C** This is a recommendation (INDG143).
B.	Anyone can carry any load as long as they are strong enough	
C.	Large loads should be broken down into smaller loads where possible	
D.	Loads should be held at arm's length while carrying	

QUESTION 2.13		
What is the recommended limit for a compact load, that can be safely carried by a fit, male worker?		
A.	50kg	**Right Answer: D** This figure is in HSE guidance, and relates to lifting and lowering at elbow height.
B.	40kg	
C.	20kg	
D.	25kg	

QUESTION 2.14		
Where there has been a major change in a manual handling operation, what should the employer do?		
A.	Monitor the operation being undertaken	**Right Answer: C** This is a specific requirement of the Manual Handling Operations regulations 1992.
B.	Review the number of people involved	
C.	Review the original risk assessment	
D.	Monitor the cost of change	

QUESTION 2.15		
What should be the first consideration when you are about to lift a load on your own?		
A.	Assess whether it is safe to lift it on your own	**Right Answer: A** Employees should assess whether there is a risk of injury before lifting. If they are not sure they should seek advice from their supervisor.
B.	Ensure you wear appropriate PPE	
C.	Wear gloves and grip properly	
D.	Ensure you lift with a bent back	

QUESTION 2.16		
Which of the following would NOT make a load easier to handle manually?		
A.	Painting it a bright colour	**Right Answer: A**
B.	Securing the load so that it does not shift unexpectedly	
C.	Reducing its weight	
D.	Providing suitable handles or hand grips	

QUESTION 2.17		
If there is a risk of injury from moving loads what should you think about?		
A.	Advising your supervisor	**Right Answer: A** This is a requirement of the Manual Handling Operations regulations 1992.
B.	Carrying it anyway	
C.	Dragging it all the way	
D.	Getting someone to assist you over the distance	

QUESTION 2.18		
As an approximate guide the manual handling capacity of a two person team is:		
A.	The sum of their individual capacities	**Right Answer: D** This is contained in HSE guidance on the Manual Handling Operations Regulations 1992.
B.	The capacity of the strongest individual	
C.	The capacity of the weakest individual	
D.	Two thirds the sum of their individual capacities	

QUESTION 2.19		
What does 'Kinetic lifting' mean?		
A.	Using a crane or some other mechanical means	**Right Answer: C**
B.	Using a forklift truck or pallet truck	
C.	Lifting in the most safe and effective way	
D.	Getting a friend to help you with the load	

QUESTION 2.20		
What should you do first before lifting or moving a load?		
A.	Put on gloves	**Right Answer: B** You or your employer must assess the risk of injury before lifting.
B.	Assess the weight	
C.	Keep a straight back	
D.	Bend your knees	

QUESTION 2.21		
Before picking up a load, you should:		
A.	Bend your knees	**Right Answer: D** You or your employer must assess the risk of injury before lifting.
B.	Choose a pair of gloves	
C.	Ask a work mate to help you	
D.	Assess the risks	

QUESTION 2.22		
When picking up an object, you should:		
A.	Bend your arms	**Right Answer: D** Generally, the legs should do most of the work when lifting a load.
B.	Bend your back	
C.	Wear a back brace	
D.	Bend your knees	

QUESTION 2.23		
When judging 'individual capability' for manual handling, you should assume:		
A.	All women are equally capable	**Right Answer: C** Assessing ability for manual handling must be done on an individual basis.
B.	Young men are weak	
C.	All people are different	
D.	All men are equally capable	

QUESTION 2.24		
When an article has to be moved for a long distance, you should:		
A.	Use a barrow or trolley	**Right Answer: A** The use of handling aids can reduce the risk of injury.
B.	Get someone else to do it for you	
C.	Drag it all the way	
D.	Carry it all the way	

QUESTION 2.25		
Which is the correct way to lift a load?		
A.	Squat near load, bend back and use leg muscles	**Right Answer: B** Handling techniques which allow the use of relatively strong leg muscles rather than those of the back are preferable.
B.	Squat near to the load, keeping the back as straight as possible and using leg muscles	
C.	Keep feet apart and bend back	
D.	Keep feet together and bend back	

QUESTION 2.26		
Which would you consider to be generally correct when lifting a load?		
A.	Larger loads should be split into smaller loads if possible	**Right Answer: A** This is a recommendation in HSE guidance (INDG143).
B.	Keep the load away from the body	
C.	When lifting you should bend your back	
D.	The feet should be together and the load lifted at arm's length	

QUESTION 2.27		
If a load has an uneven centre of gravity, how should you lift it?		
A.	Keep the heaviest side of the load away from you	**Right Answer: C** There is less risk of injury if a weight' s centre of gravity is near the torso.
B.	Keep the heaviest side of the load on the strongest arm	
C.	Keep the heaviest side of the load towards you	
D.	Keep the heaviest side of the load on the weakest arm	

REPORTING ACCIDENTS

QUESTION 3.1

What should you ensure if you suffer an injury through a manual handling operation?

A.	You get paid for the job	**Right Answer: B** All injuries must be recorded in the company accident book (BI 510).
B.	The injury is recorded	
C.	You get help and carry on working	
D.	You take time off work	

QUESTION 3.2

Why should a serious accident be reported to the enfourcing authority?

A.	It helps the site find out what caused it	**Right Answer: B** Serious accidents (specified injuries or those resulting in an absence of over 7 days) must be reported to the enforcing authority under the Reporting of Injuries, Diseases and Dangerous Occurrencs Regulations (RIDDOR).
B.	It is legal requirement	
C.	So that the site manager can see who is to blame	
D.	So that the company will be held responsible	

QUESTION 3.3

What immediate action should you take if you suffer an injury through carrying a load?

A.	Advise your doctor of your injury	**Right Answer: B** All injuries must be recorded in the company accident book (BI 510).
B.	Tell your supervisor or employer	
C.	Tell your working companion	
D.	Carry on working as best you can	

QUESTION 3.4

Under RIDDOR, which one of the following must be reported to the enforcing authority?

A.	Accidents where the injured person wishes to make a claim	**Right Answer: B** This is one of a number of reportable 'specified injuries' and must be reported to the enforcing authority under Reporting of injuries. Diseases and Dangerous Occurances Regulations (RIDDDOR).
B.	Fracture other than to fingers, thumbs or toes	
C.	All 'near misses' even if no one is hurt	
D.	All accidents casing injury	

QUESTION 3.5

Which of the following has the power to examine an accident record?

A.	An HSE inspector	**Right Answer: A** HSE inspectors have a range of powers, including this one.
B.	An Insurance company	
C.	A doctor	
D.	A workmate	

QUESTION 3.6		
Which of the following should be recorded in the accident book following an accident?		
A.	The date and time the accident occurred	**Right Answer: A** The information to be entered in an accident book (BI 510) includes when and where the accident happened, the name and address and occupation of the person who had the accident and details of how the accident happened and the injuries suffered. The weather conditions would only be included if they contributed to the accident.
B.	Your date of birth	
C.	The weather conditions	
D.	Your National Insurance Number	

QUESTION 3.7		
Which one of the following accounts for most accidents each year on construction sites?		
A.	Strikes by moving vehicles	**Right Answer: D** HSE Statistics show clearly that there are more slips, trips and falls than any other types of accident on site.
B.	Electrocution	
C.	Trench collapses	
D.	Slips, trips and falls	

QUESTION 3.8		
Which of the following is NOT classified as a specified injury to a worker under RIDDOR?		
A.	A fractured finger	**Right Answer: A** Amputation of an arm, hand, finger, thumb, leg, foot or toe are classified as specified injuries, as are bone fractures other than to fingers, thumbs or toes.
B.	A fractured arm	
C.	Amputation of a finger	
D.	A broken wrist	

QUESTION 3.9		
Which one of the following should you do if you witness a serious accident on site?		
A.	Pretend you saw nothing	**Right Answer: D** If the supervisor is aware of an accident he can take steps to prevent a recurrence. The employer also has legal duties to report certain incidents to the enforcing authority.
B.	Say nothing in case you get in trouble	
C.	Discuss what to do with your workmates	
D.	Tell your supervisor what you saw happening	

QUESTION 3.10		
A workmate tells you that he witnessed an accident the previous day and the victim was taken to hospital. He asks you for advice on what he should do. Do you tell them to:		
A.	Speak to the site nurse about what he saw	**Right Answer: B** If the supervisor is aware of an accident he can take steps to prevent a recurrence. The employer also has legal duties to report certain incidents to the enforcing authority.
B.	Tell their supervisor that they saw what happened	
C.	Telephone the hospital to find out how the injured person is	
D.	Say nothing to anyone in case they get someone in trouble	

QUESTION 3.11		
If a person at work suffers an injury (other than a specified injury) due to an accident at work, it is reportable under RIDDOR if they are incapacitated for work for:		
A.	Over 1 day	**Right Answer: B** An over-seven-day injury is one which is not a specified injury but results in the injured person being away from work or unable to do the full range of their normal duties for more than seven days (including any days they wouldn't normally be expected to work such as weekends, rest days or holidays) not counting the day of the injury itself.
B.	Over 7 days	
C.	Over half a day	
D.	Over 2 days	

QUESTION 3.12		
What must an employer do with their accident records following completion of a construction project?		
A.	They are sent to the Health and Safety Executive	**Right Answer: C** Accident records must be kept by an employer for at least three years.
B.	They are destroyed on site with other non-essential documents	
C.	They are kept safe by the employer	
D.	They are sent to the employer's insurance company	

QUESTION 3.13		
At work who would you report a dangerous occurrence to?		
A.	The emergency services	**Right Answer: B** Under RIDDOR. an employer has a legal duty to report certain work-related accidents, but to do this they will need to know that an accident has occurred.
B.	Your supervisor or employer	
C.	Another employee	
D.	The client for the project	

QUESTION 3.14		
Following a reportable dangerous occurrence when must the enforcing authority be informed?		
A.	Within 5 days	**Right Answer: C** The enforcing authority must be notified by the quickest practicable means.
B.	Within 48 hours	
C.	Without delay	
D.	Within 24 hours	

QUESTION 3.15		
Accidents causing any injury should always be recorded in:		
A.	The site engineer's day book	**Right Answer: B** All accidents should be recorded in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	Your employer's accident recording system	
C.	Your personal diary	
D.	The main contractor's diary	

QUESTION 3.16		
Which one of the following is classified as a reportable occupational disease under RIODOR?		
A.	Mental disorder	**Right Answer: B** Certain occupational diseases likely to have been caused or made worse by work are reportable under RIODOR. This would include occupational asthma where the person' s work includes significant or regular exposure to a known respiratory sensitizer.
B.	Occupational asthma	
C.	Amputation	
D.	Influenza	

QUESTION 3.17		
When a person is injured at work, who should enter the details in the accident book?		
A.	The injured person's supervisor	**Right Answer: B** This is the procedure for recording accidents internally in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	The injured person or anyone acting for them	
C.	The site manager or engineer	
D.	The site safety manager	

QUESTION 3.18		
If you are involved in a minor accident at work, whose duty is it to report it to site management?		
A.	Any witness to the accident	**Right Answer: C** Employers rely on employees to advise them of occurrences at work.
B.	The police, fire or ambulance who attend	
C.	It is your own responsibility	
D.	The site foreman should report it	

QUESTION 3.19		
You have suffered an accident at work which has made you incapable of your normal work for over 7 days. Which of the following actions MUST be taken by your employer?		
A.	The emergency services are asked to attend the site	**Right Answer: C** An over-seven-day injury is one which is not a specified injury but results in the injured person being away from work or unable to do the full range of their normal duties for more than seven days (including any days they wouldn' t normally be expected to work such as weekends, rest days or holidays) not counting the day of the injury itself.
B.	The local hospital is informed	
C.	The relevant enforcing authority is informed	
D.	A deduction is made from your wages for days lost	

QUESTION 3.20		
The collapse of scaffolding is only notifiable to the enforcing authority as a reportable dangerous occurrence when the scaffolding is which one of the following?		
A.	Over 15 metres in height	**Right Answer: D** This is one of the requirements of RIDDOR.
B.	Any height	
C.	Over 10 metres in height	
D.	Over 5 metres in height	

QUESTION 3.21		
If there is a fatal accident on site, when must the Health and Safety Executive be informed?		
A.	Without delay	**Right Answer: A** The enforcing authority must be notified by the quickest practicable means.
B.	Within 10 days	
C.	Within 7 days	
D.	Within 5 days	

QUESTION 3.22		
Under which of the following circumstances should an accident be recorded in the site's accident book?		
A.	When an accident causes damage to plant or equipment	**Right Answer: D** An accident causing an injury to an employee at work should be recorded in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	Only when a person is injured and will be off work for more than seven days	
C.	When the injury is serious enough for first aid to be needed	
D.	When an accident causes injury to an employee while at work	

QUESTION 3.23		
Which of the following have to be entered into the accident book?		
A.	All accidents causing any damage	**Right Answer: B** An accident causing an injury to an employee at work should be recorded in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	All accidents causing an injury	
C.	Only accidents causing serious injury	
D.	Only accidents causing time off work	

QUESTION 3.24		
Under which of the following circumstances must injury accidents be recorded in the accident book?		
A.	Only if you break a bone	**Right Answer: C** An accident causing an injury to an employee at work should be recorded in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	Only if you have time off work	
C.	Any time they occur	
D.	Only if you need to go to hospital	

QUESTION 3.25		
An entry must be made in the accident book when:		
A.	The person has been off sick for over seven days	**Right Answer: C** An accident causing an injury to an employee at work should be recorded in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	Management thinks it is appropriate	
C.	An accident causes personal injury to an employee	
D.	The severity of the accident may result in a compensation claim	

QUESTION 3.26		
Which of the following MUST be recorded in an accident book after you have had an accident?		
A.	Your National Insurance number	**Right Answer: C** The information to be entered in an accident book (BI 510) includes when and where the accident happened, the name, address and occupation of the person who had the accident and details of how the accident happened and the injuries suffered.
B.	Your date of birth	
C.	Your occupation	
D.	Your phone number	

QUESTION 3.27		
Which of the following can you learn from an accident?		
A.	A combination of human error and mechanical failure always causes injury	**Right Answer: B** An accident investigation should not only assess the cause, but also how similar accidents can be prevented in the future.
B.	Ideas on how you would prevent it happening again	
C.	That mechanical failures are most dangerous	
D.	How human error is always a cause	

QUESTION 3.28		
Could making an entry in the accident book help you if you later make a claim for compensation?		
A.	Only if it is a serious injury	**Right Answer: D** This is laid down in Social Security Legislation.
B.	No	
C.	Only in the event of a fatality	
D.	Yes	

QUESTION 3.29		
Why is it important to report 'near miss' accidents to your employer?		
A.	It's the law	**Right Answer: C** HSE advises that 'near misses' should be investigated to prevent their recurrence.
B.	To make the figures look good	
C.	So lessons can be learned, preventing an accident next time	
D.	So that someone can be disciplined	

QUESTION 3.30		
Who should you report serious accidents to?		
A.	Your workmate	**Right Answer: B** If the supervisor is aware of an accident he can take steps to prevent a recurrence. The employer also has legal duties to report certain incidents to the enforcing authority.
B.	Your employer or supervisor	
C.	The police	
D.	The ambulance service	

QUESTION 3.31		
What is the aim of carrying out an accident investigation?		
A.	To determine the cause(s) and prevent similar accidents	**Right Answer: A** An accident investigation should not only assess the cause, but also how similar accidents can be prevented in the future.
B.	To establish what injuries were sustained	
C.	To find out who is at fault	
D.	To establish the cost of any damage incurred	

QUESTION 3.32		
You have witnessed a serious accident on your site and are interviewed by an HSE inspector. You should:		
A.	Tell the inspector what your mates said you should say	**Right Answer: C** This is good practice, but it can also be an offence to withhold important information from an inspector.
B.	Ask your supervisor what you should say to the inspector	
C.	Co-operate fully with the inspector and tell them exactly what you saw	
D.	Don't tell them anything	

PERSONAL PROTECTIVE EQUIPMENT AT WORK

QUESTION 4.1

When working in dusty conditions, what of the following would give the LEAST level of protection?

A.	Compressed airline breathing helmet	**Right Answer: D** Protection factors are given in HSE publication HSG53 'Respiratory protective equipment at work – A practical guide'.
B.	Positive pressure powered respirator	
C.	Self-contained breathing apparatus	
D.	Half mask dust respirator	

QUESTION 4.2

In hot weather which one of the following is correct with regard to safety helmets?

A.	You can take off your helmet while working inside the building	**Right Answer: B** On construction sites, despite controls being put in place, there will always be situations where a risk of head injury remains. Taking off your helmet would put you at a much greater risk of a head injury and any unauthorised modification would be in breach of legal requirements and could render the helmet next to useless.
B.	You must continue to wear your helmet	
C.	You can drill holes in your safety hat for ventilation	
D.	You do not need to wear your helmet	

QUESTION 4.3

Which one of the following should you do if your personal protective equipment (PPE) is damaged?

A.	Obtain new equipment when available	**Right Answer: B** Employees are required to report any defective PPE to their employer (PPE at Work Regulations 1992, Regulation 7).
B.	Report to your Supervisor without delay	
C.	Reduce the amount of time you sue it	
D.	Carry on working	

QUESTION 4.4

If personal protective equipment (PPE) is defective, what should you do?

A.	Complain to the Health and Safety Inspector	**Right Answer: C** Employees are required to report any defective PPE to their employer (PPE at Work Regulations 1992, Regulation 7).
B.	Get your workmate to mend it if possible	
C.	Report it to your supervisor	
D.	Repair if possible and continue to use it	

QUESTION 4.5

In normal use, what item of PPE is NOT essential for the operator of a cartridge-operated tool, such as a nail gun?

A.	Safety eyewear	**Right Answer: C** Wellingtons do not offer protection against the specific risks associated with the use of a cartridge-operated tool, although safety footwear must always be work when there is a risk of a foot injury.
B.	Hearing protection	
C.	Wellington boots	
D.	Safety helmet	

QUESTION 4.6

Can you opt out of wearing personal protective equipment (PPE)?

A.	Yes, by informing the site supervisor	**Right Answer: C** You cannot legally 'opt out' of being protected from significant risks at work. This includes wearing the necessary PPE.
B.	Yes, by writing officially to your employer	
C.	No, you cannot opt out	
D.	Yes, if it is uncomfortable	

QUESTION 4.7		
What is the most important item of personal protective equipment (PPE) when working on or near a highway?		
A.	Safety footwear	**Right Answer: D** A high visibility vest is the most important of PPE however, the other items of PPE may also be required.
B.	Waterproof clothing	
C.	Hard hat	
D.	High visibility vest	

QUESTION 4.8		
If you are drilling into concrete with a masonry drill, in which one of the following circumstances will you need to wear eye protection?		
A.	Always	**Right Answer: A** Suitable eye protection must always be worn when working with power-driven tools where chippings are likely to fly or abrasive materials could be propelled.
B.	Only when drilling overhead	
C.	Only if the drill is bigger than 10mm	
D.	Not if drilling into the floor	

QUESTION 4.9		
When must you wear all personal protective equipment (PPE) provided by your employer?		
A.	As instructed by your employer	**Right Answer: A** Under the PPE at Work Regulations 1992, employees must wear PPE as instructed.
B.	Only if it fits	
C.	When you want to	
D.	Only when you need to	

QUESTION 4.10		
When MUST an employer provide their employees with personal protective equipment (PPE)?		
A.	When they may be exposed to a risk to their health and safety which cannot be controlled another way	**Right Answer: A** As required by regulation 4 of the PPE Regulations.
B.	Twice a year	
C.	If the client or main contractor specifies it in the contract	
D.	Every 5 years	

QUESTION 4.11		
What type of eye protection would you wear when using a cartridge-operated tool, such as a nail gun?		
A.	Impact goggles	**Right Answer: A** When using a cartridge-operated tool, such as a nail gun, shatter proof goggles should be worn.
B.	Sun glasses	
C.	Safety spectacles	
D.	Chemical protection glasses	

QUESTION 4.12		
Which of the following must your safety helmet comply with to meet with the requirements of the Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations?		
A.	It can be adjusted to suit your head size	**Right Answer: A** An assessment of the suitability of head protection would include consideration of whether it can be adjusted to suit the individual who is to wear it, that it is compatible with the work to be done and that it is comfortable to wear.
B.	It is a good visible colour	
C.	It has a label with your name on it	
D.	It is less than 1 year old	

QUESTION 4.13		
In which of the following ways should you wear your safety helmet?		
A.	With the peak raised to deflect falling material	**Right Answer: D** Any item of personal protective equipment must be used in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions, which will include how to correctly fit and wear it and what its limitations are.
B.	With the helmet back to front	
C.	With the peak raised to give good vision	
D.	Square on your head, properly adjusted	

QUESTION 4.14		
When an employee has been issued with eye protection, what are their duties under the Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations?		
A.	To ensure that they are the right type of protector	**Right Answer: C** Regulation 10(2) requires that every employee shall use any PPE in accordance with the training and instruction received.
B.	Not to loan the equipment to other operatives	
C.	To use the protection in accordance with training and instruction	
D.	To pay for replacement of lost eye protection	

QUESTION 4.15		
When should you wear safety footwear on site?		
A.	Only when working on scaffolds	**Right Answer: B** Suitable safety footwear should be worn if there is a risk of injury from objects falling onto the foot or sharp objects, such as nails, penetrating the sole.
B.	When there is a risk of a foot injury	
C.	Only when working outdoors	
D.	Only if the site conditions are wet	

QUESTION 4.16		
With regard to the use of personal protective equipment (PPE), which one of the following statements is true?		
A.	If you do not use the personal protective equipment (PPE) provided you will probably not come to any harm	**Right Answer: B** PPE is there to protect the individual. Wearing PPE does not protect other people nearby.
B.	Personal protective equipment (PPE) protects only the user from the dangers present	
C.	Personal protective equipment (PPE) need only be provided if it is not too expensive	
D.	Personal protective equipment (PPE) need only be used if it is available	

QUESTION 4.17		
Which of the following statements is TRUE when an employer issues personal protective equipment (PPE)?		
A.	The employer can charge you for the full cost of it	**Right Answer: B** Employers cannot charge for PPE such as hard hats, gloves, required by law (and the bulk of PPE is required by law).
B.	The employer cannot charge you for it	
C.	The employer can charge you for up to half the cost of it	
D.	The employer can only charge you for it if you lose or damage it	

QUESTION 4.18		
Which one of the following must apply to any hard hat provided?		
A.	It is CE or UKCA marked	**Right Answer: A** All PPE should be CE – marked, indicating that it meets the basic health and safety requirements.
B.	It is less than 5 years old	
C.	It is less than 1 year old	
D.	It is less than 2 years old	

QUESTION 4.19		
When using personal protective equipment (PPE) legally you must do which of the following?		
A.	Not interfere with it or misuse it	**Right Answer: A** Interfering with or misusing items provided in the interests of health, safety or welfare is an offence under the HSW Act 1974 (Section 8).
B.	Replace it at your own expense if it is damaged	
C.	Return it to the manufacturer when damaged	
D.	Clean it properly once a week	

QUESTION 4.20		
If it is necessary for an employee to use personal protective equipment, who has a duty to provide it?		
A.	The trade union	**Right Answer: C** This is a requirement of the PPE at Work Regulations 1992 (Regulation 4).
B.	The employee	
C.	The employer	
D.	The principal contractor	

QUESTION 4.21		
When should a safety helmet be worn on site?		
A.	At all times unless there is no foreseeable risk of injury to the head other than by falling	**Right Answer: A** The circumstances when there is no foreseeable risk of head injury from falling or swinging objects or striking the head against something will be very limited in most construction work.
B.	When you are out in the open air	
C.	When walking to and from a place of work	
D.	Only when something may fall	

QUESTION 4.22		
A colleague has drilled holes in the top of their safety helmet because the weather is hot. Is this:		
A.	Acceptable if the holes are small	**Right Answer: D** Interfering with or misusing items provided in the interests of health, safety or welfare is an offence under the HSW Act 1974 (section 8).
B.	Their choice	
C.	Acceptable	
D.	In breach of legal requirements	

QUESTION 4.23		
Who has a duty to provide PPE (Personal Protective Equipment) for use by an employee?		
A.	The employer	**Right Answer: A** This is a requirement of the PPE at Work Regulations 1992 (Regulation 4).
B.	The principal contractor	
C.	The employee	
D.	The client	

QUESTION 4.24		
When would it be appropriate to wear a bump-cap instead of a safety helmet?		
A.	When there is no foreseeable risk of injury from falling or swinging objects	**Right Answer: A** Industrial scalp protectors (bump caps) can protect against striking fixed obstacles, scalping or entanglements. They do not provide suitable protection against falling or swinging objects.
B.	In warm weather	
C.	When working in excavations	
D.	When working on a ladder	

QUESTION 4.25		
How can you protect your eyesight while working on site?		
A.	By squinting	**Right Answer: C**
B.	By not looking directly at what you are doing	
C.	By wearing the correct type of eye protection	
D.	By wearing sunglasses	

QUESTION 4.26		
When is head protection required to be worn on a construction site to comply with the Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations?		
A.	At all times except by those who are self employed	**Right Answer: D** If there is no risk of injury to the head, then hard hats are not required by law. However, on construction sites, despite controls being in place, there will almost always be situations where a risk of head injury remains and require head protection to be worn. Site rules will also require the wearing of head protection other than in any designated safe areas.
B.	Only when you feel like it	
C.	At all times unless you are working on scaffold	
D.	At all times unless there is no foreseeable risk of injury to the head other than by falling	

QUESTION 4.27		
Why should a high visibility vest be worn when working on roads?		
A.	So road users and plant operators can see you	**Right Answer: A** Many workers arestruck and injured, often seriously, by moving vehicles.
B.	Because you were told to do so	
C.	Because it will keep you warm	
D.	So that your mates can see you	

QUESTION 4.28		
When considering what measures to take to protect people's health and safety, PPE should always be regarded as:		
A.	The last resort	**Right Answer: A** Engineering controls and safe systems of work should always be considered first.
B.	The first line of defence	
C.	The best way to tackle the job	
D.	The only practical measure	

HEALTH AND HYGIENE

QUESTION 5.1

Exposure to asbestos fibres may cause which one of the following?

A.	Dermatitis	**Right Answer: D** Breathing in asbestos fibres can also lead to a number of other diseases, including lung cancer and mesothelioma.
B.	Asthma	
C.	Glandular fever	
D.	Asbestosis	

QUESTION 5.2

Asbestos is suspected in the workplace, during renovation do you:

A.	Remove it	**Right Answer: D** Competent advice must be sought, to prevent exposure to the worker or others, either at the time, or subsequently.
B.	Paint it	
C.	Ignore it	
D.	Seek guidance immediately	

QUESTION 5.3

Which of the following statements about asbestos is TRUE?

A.	Asbestos is not really a hazard to health	**Right Answer: C** All forms of asbestos can cause fatal diseases.
B.	White asbestos is safe to use	
C.	All asbestos can be a hazard to health	
D.	Only brown and blue asbestos are a hazard to health	

QUESTION 5.4

While working you discover material you think could be asbestos. What should you do?

A.	Clear any dust and fragments, put them in a bin then carry on working	**Right Answer: C** It is essential to stop work if asbestos is found or suspected, and await competent advice on what to do next.
B.	Inform the site nurse	
C.	Stop working immediately and report your suspicions to your supervisor	
D.	Dampen the material to prevent further dust being created, then carry on working	

QUESTION 5.5

Can you tell by the smell of a product whether it is likely to cause harm?

A.	No	**Right Answer: A** Many harmful substances have no smell.
B.	Only within an enclosed space	
C.	Yes	
D.	Only if you have been trained	

QUESTION 5.6

How would you recognise a hazardous substance?

A.	By a symbol on the container	**Right Answer: A** A supplier of a packaged hazardous substance must include a label on the packaging incorporating one or more hazard symbols alerting users to the dangers posed by the chemical.
B.	By its smell	
C.	The colour of the label on the container	
D.	It will be in a suitable container	

QUESTION 5.7		
Which of the following does NOT cause skin problems?		
A.	Bitumens	**Right Answer: C** Asbestos is potentially very harmful if inhaled, but does not affect the skin significantly.
B.	Solvents	
C.	Asbestos	
D.	Epoxy resins	

QUESTION 5.8		
When an assessment of hazardous substances has been carried out under the COSHH Regulations, the risks and control measures should be explained to:		
A.	The operatives using the substance	**Right Answer: A** All those working with the hazardous substances in question need to know about any risks.
B.	All employees on site	
C.	The accounts department	
D.	The person in charge of the stores	

QUESTION 5.9		
If your hands are very dirty, what should you use to get them clean?		
A.	White Spirit	**Right Answer: C** The other substances can remove natural oils from the skin.
B.	Paraffin	
C.	Soap and water	
D.	Thinners	

QUESTION 5.10		
The presence of rats on site creates a risk of catching Weil' s disease. What is the EASIEST PRACTICAL MEASURE that you can take to discourage the presence of rats?		
A.	Avoid leaving scraps of food lying about	**Right Answer: A** The easiest solution is to avoid leaving food around, since this is what attracts vermin.
B.	Lay traps containing rat poison	
C.	Contact the local Environmental Health Officer	
D.	Bring a large cat on site	

QUESTION 5.11		
Why is personal hygiene so important?		
A.	So you don't smell	**Right Answer: C**
B.	Because the COSHH regulations require it	
C.	To protect your own and others' health	
D.	To stop you catching something nasty	

QUESTION 5.12		
If you have been handling lead, how is it most likely to get into your blood stream?		
A.	By not wearing safety goggles	**Right Answer: D** The route into the body is ingestion, normally from lead contamination on the hands.
B.	By not reporting the matter to the HSE	
C.	By not using the correct safety footwear	
D.	By not washing your hands before eating	

QUESTION 5.13		
The number of toilets provided on site depends on:		
A.	The type of work being completed	**Right Answer: D** Guidance on the provision of welfare facilities is given in HSE publication 'Health and Safety in Construction'.
B.	The ratio of male and female workers on site	
C.	The duration of the work on site	
D.	The number of personnel on site	

QUESTION 5.14		
Which of the following is not required to be provided under the Construction (Design and Management) Regulations?		
A.	Toilet facilities	**Right Answer: C** Guidance on the provision of welfare facilities as required by COM is given in HSE publication 'Health and Safety in Construction'.
B.	Washing facilities	
C.	Hot food	
D.	Drinking water	

QUESTION 5.15		
The extended use of powered hand-held tools and equipment may lead to which medical condition?		
A.	Vibration white finger	**Right Answer: A** Hand-arm vibration can cause a range of conditions (including vibration white finger) collectively known as hand-arm vibration syndrome, as well as diseases such as carpal tunnel syndrome.
B.	Weil's disease	
C.	Asbestosis	
D.	Dermatitis	

QUESTION 5.16		
What must your employer do if the daily personal noise exposure is at or exceeds 85 db(A)?		
A.	Provide hearing protection to those employees who ask for it	**Right Answer: B** This is an interim measure under the Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005 when the daily personal noise exposure is at or exceeds the upper exposure action value of 85 dB(A). Exposure should subsequently be reduced by implementing organizational or technical measures.
B.	Issue hearing protection to those exposed and ensure that it is worn	
C.	Tell employees to buy their own hearing protection	
D.	Report it to the Health and Safety Executive	

QUESTION 5.17		
What are the lower and upper action values with regard to daily personal noise exposure, as defined in the Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005?		
A.	85 dB(A) and 90 dB(A)	**Right Answer: B** Daily personal noise exposure is the average noise level experienced by an individual over an 8 hour period.
B.	80 dB(A) and 85 dB(A)	
C.	70 dB(A) and 80 dB(A)	
D.	75 dB(A) and 85dB(A)	

QUESTION 5.18		
At or above what level of daily personal noise exposure does an employer have to provide hearing protection if it is requested by an employee?		
A.	90 dB(A)	**Right Answer: C** This is one of the duties of employers under the Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005 when the lower exposure action value of 80 dB(A) is reached or exceeded.
B.	95 dB(A)	
C.	80 dB(A)	
D.	85 dB(A)	

QUESTION 5.19		
The effects of damage to your hearing by long-term exposure to high noise levels:		
A.	Can be corrected by an operation	**Right Answer: B** Hearing damage due to long-term noise exposure is irreversible.
B.	Are permanent	
C.	Will be reduced when you change jobs	
D.	Can be reversed to near normal with time	

QUESTION 5.20		
Hearing protection should be worn:		
A.	In designated areas	**Right Answer: A** Employees must wear hearing protectors when exposed at or above the upper exposure action values and within hearing protection zones.
B.	In noisy internal areas only	
C.	At any workplace	
D.	Only on building sites	

QUESTION 5.21		
Wearing suitable hearing protection:		
A.	Stops you hearing distracting conversations	**Right Answer: C** Hearing protection still allows some noise to reach the ear, but, if it has been correctly chosen, will reduce noise levels to an acceptable level.
B.	Stops you hearing all noise	
C.	Brings noise down to an acceptable level	
D.	Repairs damaged hearing	

QUESTION 5.22		
Which of the following is one of the recommended means of protecting your hearing?		
A.	Rolled tissue paper	**Right Answer: D** The others are not considered to be suitable types of hearing protection.
B.	Cotton wool pads	
C.	Soft cloth pads	
D.	Ear defenders	

QUESTION 5.23		
Which of the following would NOT reduce the risks from hand-arm vibration when using a hammer action tool?		
A.	Selecting the lowest vibration tool that is suitable and which can do the work efficiently	**Right Answer: D** Where tools require constant or frequent use, rotas will avoid individuals having long exposure to vibration. The use of low-vibration tools and keeping the hands warm in cold conditions will also reduce the risks.
B.	Wearing gloves to keep the hands warm	
C.	Working as a team to share the work out	
D.	Making sure one person does all the work with the tool	

QUESTION 5.24		
Which of the following animals can carry Weil's disease?		
A.	Snake	**Right Answer: C** Weil's disease is a serious and sometimes fatal infection that can be transmitted to humans by contact with infected rats. Another form of Leptospirosis infection can be transmitted from cattle to humans.
B.	Sheep	
C.	Rat	
D.	Pig	

QUESTION 5.25		
You are most likely to catch Weil's disease (Leptospirosis) if you:		
A.	Work near wet ground, waterways or sewers	**Right Answer: A** Anyone who is exposed to rat urine is at risk, particularly sewer workers and farmers. Those in contact with canal or river water are also at risk.
B.	Work near air conditioning units	
C.	Fix showers or baths	
D.	Drink water from a standpipe	

QUESTION 5.26		
What should you do if the toilets on your site are continually dirty?		
A.	Ignore the problem – its normal on a construction site	**Right Answer: B** How often welfare facilities on site require cleaning will depend on the number of people on site and how quickly they get dirty. The person in control of the site should make sure someone is responsible for keeping the facilities clean and tidy.
B.	Make sure you tell someone who can sort it out	
C.	Find some cleaning materials and clean it up yourself	
D.	Ask in a nearby cafe or pub if you can use their toilets	

QUESTION 5.27		
Excessive sunlight on bare skin can cause which serious health problem?		
A.	Dermatitis	**Right Answer: D** Ultraviolet rays in sunlight can cause sunburn and premature ageing of the skin. The most serious effect, however, is an increased chance of developing skin cancer.
B.	Rickets	
C.	Acne	
D.	Skin cancer	

FIRE AND EMERGENCY

QUESTION 6.1

An emergency route(s) must be provided on construction sites to ensure:

A.	Safe passage to the open air	**Right Answer: C**
B.	Safe passage to the rest area	
C.	Safe passage to a secure place of safety	
D.	Safe passage to the ground from height	

QUESTION 6.2

What action should you take if you discover a fire?

A.	Leave it because you will get the blame	**Right Answer: B** Raising the alarm will reduce the risk to others, particularly if the fire spreads.
B.	Raise the alarm	
C.	Carry on working if it is safe to do so	
D.	Extinguish the fire without raising the alarm	

QUESTION 6.3

If there had been a small fire, who should you report it to?

A.	Your supervisor	**Right Answer: A** The supervisor should be aware, so that further preventative measures can be considered.
B.	The main contractor's site agent	
C.	The site's fire marshal	
D.	The resident site engineer	

QUESTION 6.4

If you discover a fire at work, what should you do first:

A.	Telephone 999	**Right Answer: D** Raising the alarm will reduce the risk to others, particularly if the fire spreads.
B.	Use a fire extinguisher to put it out	
C.	Run around looking for an alarm to sound	
D.	Raise the alarm and warn fellow workers	

QUESTION 6.5

What is a fire assembly point?

A.	The place to go when the fire alarm sounds	**Right Answer: A** It is essential that people go to a place of safety, where supervisors or fire marshals know where they are, in the event of a fire.
B.	A place where the fire brigade goes to	
C.	A place where fire extinguishers are kept	
D.	The place where the fire alarm is	

QUESTION 6.6

Where would you go in the event of a fire?

A.	To the canteen for a cup of tea	**Right Answer: B** It is essential that people go to a place of safety, where supervisors or fire marshals know where they are, in the event of a fire.
B.	To the fire assembly point	
C.	To the site hut	
D.	To the fire to see what is going on	

QUESTION 6.7		
What should you do if you hear the fire alarm?		
A.	Ignore it because it might be someone playing around	**Right Answer: C** It is essential that people go to a place of safety, where supervisors or fire marshals know where they are, in the event of a fire.
B.	Leave work for the day	
C.	Evacuate the premises to a designated place of safety	
D.	Go towards the sound to find out what is going on	

QUESTION 6.8		
All new fire extinguishers are coloured red or of bright self-coloured metal. How do you know the difference between types?		
A.	A different colour panel or band is on the body of the extinguishers	**Right Answer: A** Different coloured bands show extinguisher types e.g. black for CO2 and blue for dry powder.
B.	During site induction, you will be told where the different types of extinguishers are	
C.	The weight and shape of the extinguisher	
D.	The type of extinguisher is written on a sign next to it	

QUESTION 6.9		
A black-labelled fire extinguisher contains:		
A.	Dry powder	**Right Answer: D**
B.	Water	
C.	Foam	
D.	Carbon dioxide	

QUESTION 6.10		
What is a blue-labelled fire extinguisher filled with?		
A.	Water	**Right Answer: C**
B.	Foam	
C.	Dry powder	
D.	Carbon dioxide	

QUESTION 6.11		
Which fire extinguisher should not be used on flammable liquid fires?		
A.	Carbon dioxide	**Right Answer: C** Flammable liquids spread if attacked by water extinguishers.
B.	Powder	
C.	Water	
D.	Foam	

QUESTION 6.12		
What colour is a water filled fire extinguisher, or its label?		
A.	Black	**Right Answer: C**
B.	Cream	
C.	Red	
D.	Green	

QUESTION 6.13		
When discharging carbon dioxide fire extinguishers, the nozzle:		
A.	Becomes warm	**Right Answer: C** The expansion of CO2 gas coming out of the nozzle causes rapid cooling.
B.	Becomes very hot	
C.	Becomes very cold	
D.	Doesn't change temperature	

QUESTION 6.14		
For fires involving spilled petrol, which types of fire extinguisher could you use?		
A.	Water, carbon dioxide or foam	**Right Answer: C** Flammable liquids, such as petrol, spread if attacked by water extinguishers.
B.	Water, foam or dry powder	
C.	Foam, carbon dioxide or dry powder	
D.	Water, carbon dioxide or dry powder	

QUESTION 6.15		
Which types of fire extinguishers should be used on electrical fires?		
A.	Foam and water	**Right Answer: B** Liquids should not be used, since they may conduct electricity.
B.	Carbon dioxide and dry powder	
C.	Dry powder and foam	
D.	Water and carbon dioxide	

QUESTION 6.16		
A red-labelled fire extinguisher should NOT be used:		
A.	On wood fires	**Right Answer: B** Red denotes water. Liquids should not be used on electrical fires, since they can conduct electricity.
B.	Where there is a risk of electrocution	
C.	On burning clothes	
D.	On burning furniture	

QUESTION 6.17		
A workmate burns their hand on a piece of very hot metal. What should you do first?		
A.	Rub some cream or Vaseline into the burn	**Right Answer: D** Burns need immediate and sustained cooling.
B.	Cover the burn with something dry	
C.	Warn other people about the piece of hot metal	
D.	Put their hand in cold water if it is available	

QUESTION 6.18		
Which of the following items should not be in a first aid box?		
A.	Safety pins	**Right Answer: B** Drugs must not be kept in a first aid box (Health and Safety guidance note INDG 214).
B.	Pain killers	
C.	Disposable gloves	
D.	Triangular bandages	

QUESTION 6.19		
How often should a first-aider qualified in First Aid at Work (FAW) or Emergency First Aid at Work (EFAW) receive retraining?		
A.	Every six months	**Right Answer: C** First Aid at Work (FAW) and Emergency First Aid at Work (EFAW) certificates are valid for three years and first-aiders are required to undertake retraining at the end of this period. However, the HSE also strongly recommends that first-aiders undertake annual (half-day) refresher training.
B.	Every two years	
C.	Every three years	
D.	Every four years	

QUESTION 6.20		
If you came across an injury on site, what is the first thing you should do?		
A.	Tell the casualty to visit their doctor	**Right Answer: C** Competent first-aid treatment is essential, and should be summoned immediately.
B.	Inform the HSE	
C.	Contact a first-aider	
D.	Try and find out what happened	

QUESTION 6.21		
An employee has a fall and is obviously unconscious. What is the FIRST thing you should do?		
A.	Send someone for the first-aider	**Right Answer: A** Competent first-aid treatment is essential, and should be summoned immediately.
B.	Find out if there were any witnesses	
C.	Try to protect them from any further injury	
D.	Put them in the recovery position	

QUESTION 6.22		
A labourer gets an electric shock; looks a bit pale but says they are alright. What should you do?		
A.	Send someone for the first-aider	**Right Answer: A** Competent first-aid treatment is essential, and should be summoned immediately.
B.	Tell them to report it to their supervisor	
C.	Go and check the electrics so it cannot happen again	
D.	See if they want a drink or a cigarette	

QUESTION 6.23		
Which of the following must an employer consider when making provisions for first aid?		
A.	How much working space will be wasted	**Right Answer: D** Employers must match first-aid provision to the nature of risks at work.
B.	How much will it cost	
C.	Whether the local ambulance service can be used	
D.	The likely types of injury	

QUESTION 6.24		
In an on-site emergency, which of the following must a first-aider NOT do?		
A.	Treat an unconscious patient	**Right Answer: D** First-aid is concerned with preserving life and limb, and first-aiders are not trained to dispense medical treatments.
B.	Control bleeding	
C.	Give resuscitation	
D.	Give medicines to patients without authorisation	

QUESTION 6.25		
If someone has fallen over and has stopped breathing, what is the first thing you should do?		
A.	Send for help	**Right Answer: A** Do not delay in sending for help; **then** try to start the casualty breathing.
B.	Attend to any broken bones	
C.	Try to give the casualty a drink	
D.	Try to start the casualty breathing	

QUESTION 6.26		
If someone has fallen off a ladder and they say their leg is broken, what should you do?		
A.	Send for the first-aider	**Right Answer: A** Competent first-aid treatment is essential, and should be summoned immediately.
B.	Help them to the cabin or mess hut	
C.	Move the ladder so no-one trips over it	
D.	Bandage their legs together	

QUESTION 6.27		
Your workmate suddenly gets a foreign body in the eye. What should you do?		
A.	Take your workmate to the supervisor	**Right Answer: D** Competent first-aid treatment is essential, and should be summoned immediately.
B.	Use a clean handkerchief to try and remove it	
C.	Wash your hands before touching your mate's face	
D.	Send someone for the first-aider	

QUESTION 6.28		
A person nearly collapses complaining of stomach pains. What should you do?		
A.	Send someone for the first-aider	**Right Answer: A** Competent first-aid treatment is essential, and should be summoned immediately.
B.	Go and find them something to drink	
C.	Help them to find somewhere comfortable to sit	
D.	Ask them if they want something to eat	

QUESTION 6.29		
A workmate lifting a big box suddenly shouts 'oh, my back' and drops the box. What should you do?		
A.	Tell them to leave it for someone else to lift	**Right Answer: B** The priority for any back injury is to obtain first-aid advice, in order to prevent further damage.
B.	Send for the first-aider	
C.	Help them to lift the box	
D.	Find them somewhere comfortable to sit and rest	

QUESTION 6.30		
What should you do immediately if you get a small cut on a finger whilst at work?		
A.	Carry on working	**Right Answer: B** It is important to obtain first-aid to prevent further harm (e.g. through infection). It should also be recorded in the accident book (BI 510).
B.	Get first-aid	
C.	Ask your employer to report it to the HSE	
D.	Just wash it clean	

QUESTION 6.31		
In an emergency situation at work you should do what?		
A.	Phone the HSE Inspectorate	**Right Answer: B** A site emergency plan should have been drawn up and you should be familiar with the emergency procedure.
B.	Obey the site emergency procedure	
C.	Ensure your work mates are all accounted for	
D.	Leave the site immediately	

QUESTION 6.32		
What does the sound of a siren on-site normally indicate?		
A.	A fire	**Right Answer: D**
B.	A toxic escape	
C.	An explosion	
D.	An emergency	

QUESTION 6.33		
The purpose of fire-stopping in a building is to:		
A.	Prevent a fire starting	**Right Answer: B** Fire-stopping is a passive fire protection measure used to seal any openings created in a fire resistance-rated wall or floor assembly, e.g. to allow pipes or wiring systems to pass through. During fire conditions this will impede the spread of fire and smoke.
B.	Delay the passage of fire and smoke through openings in walls and floors	
C.	Activate fire sprinklers	
D.	Set off the fire alarm	

QUESTION 6.34		
What are fire-stops designed to do?		
A.	Extinguish a fire	**Right Answer: D** Fire-stops are designed to maintain the fireproofing of a wall or floor assembly. Fire-stopping delays the spread of fire and, generally, the spread of smoke as well.
B.	Protect services (such as wiring systems) against fire damage	
C.	Close fire doors automatically	
D.	Delay the passage of fire and smoke through openings in walls and floors	

QUESTION 6.35		
In addition to preserving fire separation between areas of a building, which other important fire safety function can fire-stopping achieve?		
A.	Preventing premature structural collapse	**Right Answer: A** During a fire it is essential that the load-bearing capacity of elements of the building structure are maintained until occupants have escaped. Timber studs, joists or 'I' beams, for example, may only have a short survival time if exposed to fire and may rely on linings, such as a plasterboard ceiling, for fire-resistance. Services passing through such linings should therefore be fire-stopped.
B.	Reducing nuisance fire alarms	
C.	Reducing noise transmission	
D.	Saving energy	

QUESTION 6.36		
Intumescent materials used to provide fire-stopping are designed to:		
A.	Expand when subjected to smoke	**Right Answer: C** A limited number of fire-resistant materials may be used to provide fire-stopping. These include intumescent products, which are designed to expand and provide fire-stopping when subjected to heat. Examples include intumescent 'pillows'.
B.	Shrink when subjected to heat	
C.	Expand when subjected to heat	
D.	Prevent noise transmission	

QUESTION 6.37		
What should you do if you disturb fire-stopping around a wiring system penetrating a wall or floor whilst carrying out work?		
A.	Nail a piece of wood over any gaps	**Right Answer: B** It is essential that the integrity of fire compartments is maintained during the construction of buildings and on their completion. Compromising compartmentation, such as failing to adequately fire-stop (seal) openings for services to pass through, can undermine fire precautions catastrophically. Only a limited range of products are suitable and they must be correctly applied to provide the required degree of fire-stopping.
B.	Ensure that the fire-stopping is reinstated to the necessary standard as soon as possible	
C.	Highlight this on any certification	
D.	Fill any holes or gaps with squashed newspaper	

QUESTION 6.38		
If you discover a hole or gap in a fire rated wall or floor that has not been fire-stopped, what should you do?		
A.	Report it to your supervisor without delay	**Right Answer: A** Supervisors need to be made aware of any observed inadequacies in fire-stopping - which can undermine fire precautions catastrophically during the construction of buildings and on their completion. Only a limited range of products are suitable and they must be correctly applied to provide the required degree of fire-stopping.
B.	Ignore it unless it is causing a draught	
C.	Cover the hole or gap with insulating tape	
D.	Use decorators' sealant to fill the gap	

QUESTION 6.39		
Which one of the following is associated with a Higher Risk Building (HRBs) in England?		
A.	At least 18 metres in height or seven storeys	**Right Answer: A** At least 18 meters in height or seven storeys is the height at which the Building Safety Regulator regime will apply in England.
B.	At least 15 metres in height or seven storeys	
C.	At least 15 metres in height or six storeys	
D.	At least 18 metres in height or six storeys	

QUESTION 6.40		
For a holistic approach to fire safety - to plan for all aspects of fire safety - the three main areas that need to be considered are design, construction and...		
A.	Occupation	**Right Answer: C** Design, construction and maintenance are the main aspects to be considered as part of a holistic view to fire safety covering all elements to cover all aspects.
B.	Fire stopping	
C.	Maintenance	
D.	Demolition	

QUESTION 6.41		
Which of the following materials provide the least effective fire resistance?		
A.	Brick	**Right Answer: C** Timber or wood has a low ignition point and can be highly flammable, generally considered to have poor fire resistance.
B.	Concrete	
C.	Timber	
D.	Steel	

QUESTION 6.42		
When man-made substances, such as rubber, burn, the colour of the smoke is typically:		
A.	White	**Right Answer: B** The black colour of smoke from burning man-made substances, including rubber, is primarily due to incomplete combustion of carbon-based materials, and soot particles suspended in the air making the smoke appear black.
B.	Black	
C.	Grey	
D.	Yellow	

QUESTION 6.43		
Which one of the following is a benefit of a 'stay put' strategy for fire evacuation in high risk buildings?		
A.	It slows the fire fighters' response to a fire	**Right Answer: C** A 'stay-put' strategy is designed to prevent injury, reduce panic, and reduce smoke inhalation which could cause injury or fatalities.
B.	It reduces communication between occupants and emergency services	
C.	You reduce the risk of entering a smoky corridor and being overcome by smoke	
D.	It allows lifts to be used more effectively	

QUESTION 6.44		
Which one of the following is not a requirement of a protected escape route?		
A.	Leads to a safe place	**Right Answer: C** Although emergency lighting systems are mandated to provide adequate illumination in escape routes, this does not include infra-red lights specifically.
B.	Protection from smoke	
C.	Infra-red lights	
D.	Protection from fire	

QUESTION 6.45		
Which one of the following is not an area of competence?		
A.	Skills	**Right Answer: B** Competence is broadly defined as the skills, knowledge, experience, and behaviours of an individual.
B.	Resilience	
C.	Knowledge	
D.	Behaviours	

QUESTION 6.46		
What is a key consideration for individuals to ensure safety at work?		
A.	Pushing personal limits to complete a job at any cost	**Right Answer: C** Competence includes the recognition and awareness of the limitations of your own competence, and not undertaking jobs or tasks for which you haven't received proper training as this will lead to unsafe and potentially dangerous practices.
B.	Having a go at jobs without proper training	
C.	Recognising the limitations of competence and not exceeding your own limitations	
D.	Ignoring boundaries to complete a job in the quickest manner possible	

QUESTION 6.47		
Which one of the following is a consequence of poor workmanship?		
A.	Improved fire safety	**Right Answer: C** A lack of competence and poor workmanship can lead to increased servicing and maintenance requirements, and increased hazards as a result.
B.	A good reputation	
C.	Increase in hazard and servicing	
D.	Increased structural stability	

QUESTION 6.48		
What is CROSS-UK?		
A.	A branch of the British Red Cross for Construction Workers	**Right Answer: C** CROSS-UK is Collaborative Reporting for Safer Structures UK – a confidential reporting system which allows professionals working in the built environment to report on fire or structural safety issues.
B.	An online forum for workers to complain about their employers	
C.	A confidential reporting system to report on fire and structural safety issues	
D.	A charity that supplies work equipment to apprentices	

WORK AT HEIGHT

QUESTION 7.1

Most deaths on site are caused by:

A.	Vehicle movements	**Right Answer: B** Although the other dangers can kill or cause injury, falling from height is the bigger cause of fatalities.
B.	Falling from height	
C.	Solvent inhalation	
D.	Chemical burns	

QUESTION 7.2

The type of accident that kills most construction site workers is:

A.	Being hit by falling objects	**Right Answer: B** Although the other dangers can kill or cause injury, falling from height is the biggest cause of fatalities.
B.	Falling from heights	
C.	Trench collapses	
D.	Electrical accident	

QUESTION 7.3

The main cause of deaths on construction sites is…

A.	Fire	**Right Answer: B**
B.	Falls from height	
C.	Being run over by plant	
D.	Excavation collapse	

QUESTION 7.4

How many people should be working on a ladder at one time?

A.	One on each section of an extension ladder	**Right Answer: B** Only one person should be working on a ladder, although another person may be footing it, for extra stability.
B.	One	
C.	Two	
D.	Three if it is long enough	

QUESTION 7.5

Ladders should be set at a slope of approximately:

A.	1 out for every 3 up	**Right Answer: D**
B.	4 out for every 1 up	
C.	1 out for every 1 up	
D.	1 out for every 4 up	

QUESTION 7.6

Why should aluminium ladders be kept away from wet lime or cement?

A.	It will stain your clothes	**Right Answer: C** Aluminium can corrode in certain situations, notably if in prolonged contact with lime or cement.
B.	The ladder may become statically charged	
C.	It may corrode the ladder	
D.	It will stain the aluminium	

QUESTION 7.7		
Before being used, a ladder should be inspected:		
A.	By the foreman	**Right Answer: B** The user needs to be satisfied that the ladder is in a safe condition before using it.
B.	By the user	
C.	By the manufacturer	
D.	By the Safety Officer	

QUESTION 7.8		
Ladders should be:		
A.	In good condition	**Right Answer: C** All the measures listed are required to reduce the risk of falls.
B.	Tied or footed	
C.	Tied or footed AND at the right angle AND in good condition	
D.	At the right angle	

QUESTION 7.9		
A ladder giving access to a scaffold can generally be safely used, provided that:		
A.	The foot of the ladder is firmly wedged	**Right Answer: D** Access ladders should extend at least 1 metre above the landing point to provide a safe handhold.
B.	It does not move when you climb up it	
C.	Any broken rungs are clearly marked	
D.	It is tied and extends at least 1 metre above the platform	

QUESTION 7.10		
What is the ideal angle for a ladder against a wall and floor?		
A.	One metre up for every metre out from the wall	**Right Answer: D** The correct angle for a ladder is 75 degrees, which can be judged using the angle indicator marked on the stiles of some ladders or using the 1 in 4 rule.
B.	One metre up for every two metres out from the wall	
C.	Two metres up for every metre out from the wall	
D.	Four metres up for every metre out from the wall	

QUESTION 7.11		
The rung of a wooden ladder has started to split, what should you do?		
A.	Do not use it, tell your supervisor	**Right Answer: A** It is essential that supervisors are aware of faulty or damaged equipment.
B.	Cut the bad bit out	
C.	Tape it up	
D.	Jump on it to see if it holds your weight	

QUESTION 7.12		
Ladders should not be painted because:		
A.	Regular repainting will be necessary	**Right Answer: D**
B.	The paint will make them slippery to use	
C.	The paint may not be suitable on metal parts of the ladder	
D.	The paint may cover a defect or damaged part of the ladder	

QUESTION 7.13		
When can you work from a ladder?		
A.	For short periods and then only if it is safe to do so	**Right Answer: A** Ladders are primarily means of access, not workplaces. They can be worked from, but only if the use of other, more suitable, work equipment is not appropriate and the task is of low risk and of short duration.
B.	When it is long enough	
C.	When it is available	
D.	When not being used for access	

QUESTION 7.14		
When working above public areas, what should be considered?		
A.	Preventing complaints from the public	**Right Answer: B** There is a significant risk to the public from falling materials, if this is not considered before and during work.
B.	The danger of falling materials	
C.	Keeping the job going	
D.	Keeping the areas open to the public	

QUESTION 7.15		
A scaffold tower must be erected by:		
A.	A trained and competent person	**Right Answer: A** There are a number of organizations that provide training for the safe erection and use of scaffold towers.
B.	The hire company who supply it	
C.	The site foreman	
D.	Senior site staff	

QUESTION 7.16		
What is the minimum height of the top guard-rail of a scaffold above the edge from which someone is liable to fall?		
A.	470mm	**Right Answer: C** This is a requirement of the Work at Height Regulations 2005.
B.	910mm	
C.	950mm	
D.	2 metres	

QUESTION 7.17		
A working platform used for construction work, and from which a person could fall 2 metres or more, must not be used unless it has been inspected (and a report is subsequently prepared) by a competent person:		
A.	Only after an accident	**Right Answer: C** Under these specific circumstances a report is required to be prepared by the competent person and given to the person for whom the inspection was done (e.g. the site manager). This is in addition to the more general requirement to inspect equipment for work at height: prior to use in that position (or site if it is mobile); following exceptional circumstances (e.g. high winds); and at suitable intervals.
B.	That day	
C.	Within the previous seven days	
D.	Within the previous month	

QUESTION 7.18		
On a mobile elevating work platform, what should you attach your safety harness to?		
A.	A secure anchorage point inside the platform	**Right Answer: A** The priority is to stay within the platform (which is the safest place) and in any event you cannot be sure of the strength of other fixtures.
B.	A strong part of the structure you are working on	
C.	The boom of the machine	
D.	A nearby pipe or scaffold	

QUESTION 7.19		
You have been asked to operate a cherry-picker (mobile elevated work platform) when it is very windy. What should your FIRST consideration be?		
A.	Wear a safety harness and clip it to the structure that you are working on	**Right Answer: B** The priority in safety is eliminating risk at source – in this case by not working in dangerous conditions – rather than trying to stay safe by using protective equipment.
B.	Does the wind-speed make it unsafe to use the machine	
C.	Wear an extra layer of clothing to keep warm	
D.	Tie all light-weight objects to the hand-rails of the basket	

QUESTION 7.20		
If you have to work at height and it is not possible to erect a scaffold, or use any other type of working platform or mobile elevating work platform, then you should:		
A.	Work without fall protection, provided you have a mate with you	**Right Answer: B** The harness will greatly reduce the likelihood of injury if you fall.
B.	Wear a harness and lanyard at all times	
C.	Work without fall protection, provided the weather is not too windy	
D.	Work without fall protection at all times when no one else is about	

QUESTION 7.21		
When working on a roof that has fragile, clear-plastic panels, what is the best way of preventing falls through the panels?		
A.	Make sure that everyone is told where the panels are and to avoid treading on them	**Right Answer: B** Protection from falling through openings and fragile roof lights can be provided by barriers or with covers which can be secured or labelled with a warning.
B.	Cover the fragile panels with a strong material and secure the covers to stop them being dislodged	
C.	Remove the panels carefully to leave an open space.	
D.	It shouldn' t be necessary to do anything, everyone knows the dangers	

QUESTION 7.22		
When working on a roof that has fragile, clear-plastic panels, what is the best way of preventing falls through the panels?		
A.	It is safe to walk on the purlins	**Right Answer: D** Fragile roofs must be made safe to work on, before work commences.
B.	Walk straight across the roof to where you need to get to	
C.	As long as you avoid any fragile areas it is safe	
D.	Crawling boards should always be used	

QUESTION 7.23		
Half the deaths on construction sites are caused by which one of the following?		
A.	Falls from heights	**Right Answer: A** This is shown by HSE statistics.
B.	Electrical misuse	
C.	Working in trenches/confined spaces	
D.	Misuse of plant and machinery	

QUESTION 7.24		
What should you do if your work activity requires you to wear a full body safety harness and one is not available?		
A.	Make a harness from items found on site	**Right Answer: D** Always advise the supervisor if you do not have the correct PPE.
B.	Carry on working and hope that everything will be alright	
C.	Borrow a harness from a colleague	
D.	Stop work immediately and tell your supervisor that you do not have the correct PPE	

QUESTION 7.25		
Under what circumstances do the Work at Height Regulations permit a stepladder to be used on site?		
A.	Never – stepladders are banned	**Right Answer: D** The WAH Regulations have not banned the use of ladders or stepladders, but they should be used sensibly.
B.	At any time	
C.	Provided you can't fall 2 metres or more	
D.	Only when a risk assessment shows that safer alternatives have been ruled out and the task is of low risk and of short duration	

QUESTION 7.26		
What is the best method of securing a ladder?		
A.	Tying it to a suitable point	**Right Answer: A** Tying the ladder is the safest option, making sure both stiles are tied.
B.	Using an effective ladder stability device	
C.	Wedging the ladder (e.g. against a wall)	
D.	Having the ladder footed	

QUESTION 7.27		
Of the following, which is the POOREST method of securing a ladder?		
A.	Securing the base of the ladder	**Right Answer: C** Footing a ladder is the last resort and should be avoided. Other more suitable access equipment should be used where practicable.
B.	Tying the ladder	
C.	Having someone foot the ladder	
D.	Using a ladder stability device	

QUESTION 7.28		
Prior to moving a mobile tower scaffold, the platform height should reduced to a maximum of:		
A.	2 metres	**Right Answer: C** This figure is quoted in guidance published by the HSE and PASMA. Checks should also be made that there are no obstructions overhead, the ground is firm, level and free from potholes, it is not too windy and there are no people or materials on the tower.
B.	3 metres	
C.	4 metres	
D.	5 metres	

WORK EQUIPMENT

QUESTION 8.1

What do the letters SWL stand for?

A.	Safe working level	**Right Answer: D** Machinery and accessories for lifting loads should be clearly marked to indicate their safe working loads.
B.	Satisfactory weight limit	
C.	Satisfactory working limit	
D.	Safe working load	

QUESTION 8.2

Who should operate plant and equipment on site?

A.	Only people over 18 years of age	**Right Answer: B** Never operate plant or equipment unless you have been trained and are authorised to do so.
B.	Trained and authorised employees only	
C.	An employee holding a full driving licence	
D.	Any experienced employee	

QUESTION 8.3

What hazard is created when the head of a cold chisel mushrooms?

A.	Reduced striking area	**Right Answer: C** This question is looking for the hazard, which is the situation that can cause harm to people.
B.	Softens the impact	
C.	Flying steel splinters	
D.	Damage to the hammer head	

QUESTION 8.4

Any damaged equipment must be:

A.	Reported to your supervisor	**Right Answer: A** It is essential that supervisors are aware of faulty or damaged equipment.
B.	Thrown away immediately	
C.	Labelled as damaged before use	
D.	Locked up so no one can use it	

QUESTION 8.5

The electric drill you are about to use has a faulty on/off switch. What action should you take?

A.	Try and fix the fault	**Right Answer: C** It is essential that supervisors are aware of faulty or damaged equipment.
B.	Find another machine and carry on working	
C.	Remove it from use and tell your supervisor	
D.	Tape the switch on to keep it running and carry on working	

QUESTION 8.6

The power hand tool you are about to use has burn marks visible on the cable. What should you do?

A.	Tape over the affected area and continue	**Right Answer: B** It is essential that supervisors are aware of faulty or damaged equipment.
B.	Tell your supervisor about the defect and do not use the tool	
C.	Obtain another machine and carry on, but don't tell anyone	
D.	Carry on and get the job done	

QUESTION 8.7		
Your supervisor asks you to use a powered hand-tool which has a rotating blade. You notice that the guard is missing from the blade. What do you do?		
A.	Use the tool anyway, you haven't had an accident with it before	**Right Answer: B** It is essential that supervisors are aware of faulty or damaged equipment.
B.	Remove it from use and tell your supervisor	
C.	Try to make an improvised guard yourself	
D.	Contact the manufacturer of the tool	

QUESTION 8.8		
Hand and power tools must be:		
A.	The best that you can buy	**Right Answer: D** Tools must not create a risk to the user or others. This means they must be suitable and kept in good condition. This requires inspection before use.
B.	Made available when needed	
C.	In the company's colours	
D.	Suitable for the task and regularly inspected	

QUESTION 8.9		
When should visual checks of portable hand-held equipment be made by the user?		
A.	When a replacement is needed	**Right Answer: D** The user needs to be satisfied that the tool has no obvious defect before use.
B.	Monthly	
C.	Weekly	
D.	Each time it is used	

QUESTION 8.10		
What precaution should you take before adjusting an electrical tool?		
A.	Check the lead is not twisted or knotted	**Right Answer: C** Do not adjust tools which could still be live or operate.
B.	Wear safety footwear with steel toe caps	
C.	Disconnect from the power source	
D.	Wear the correct personal protective equipment	

QUESTION 8.11		
An electric drill is to be used. Before use, who should carry out a check on the tool?		
A.	Storeman	**Right Answer: D** The user needs to be satisfied that the tool has no obvious defect before use.
B.	Electrician	
C.	Foreman	
D.	User	

QUESTION 8.12		
What action should you take if an electric drill cuts out while you are using it?		
A.	Shake it about a bit	**Right Answer: D** The drill may be faulty. If so, tell your supervisor and remove the drill from service.
B.	Put it back into the tool box	
C.	Switch the power off and on	
D.	Remove it from use and tell your supervisor	

QUESTION 8.13		
If an electric drill gives off blue smoke from the motor, you should:		
A.	Pour water over it	**Right Answer: C** Defective electric hand tools must not be used. Stop what you are doing and inform your supervisor.
B.	Use a CO^2 extinguisher	
C.	Switch it off and report it	
D.	Stop work for 30 minutes	

QUESTION 8.14		
How often should user (visual) checks be carried out on portable electrical equipment?		
A.	Every time you use it	**Right Answer: A** All items of portable electrical equipment should be visually checked for safety by the user before being put into use.
B.	Every day	
C.	Once a week	
D.	At least once a year	

QUESTION 8.15		
What is the preferred nominal voltage for portable hand lamps for general use on construction sites?		
A.	110 volts	**Right Answer: A** 110 volt reduced low voltage systems are strongly preferred for the supply to such equipment.
B.	150 volts	
C.	230 volts	
D.	400 volts	

QUESTION 8.16		
What is the preferred nominal voltage for portable hand tools on construction sites?		
A.	12 volts	**Right Answer: C** 110 volt reduced low voltage systems are strongly preferred for the supply to such equipment.
B.	24 volts	
C.	110 volts	
D.	230 volts	

QUESTION 8.17		
What is the preferred nominal voltage for local lighting up to 2 kW on construction sites?		
A.	55 volts	**Right Answer: B** 110 volt reduced low voltage systems are strongly preferred for the supply to such equipment.
B.	110 volts	
C.	400 volts	
D.	230 volts	

QUESTION 8.18		
What is the recommended **maximum** voltage for portable hand lamps when working in confined or damp locations?		
A.	50 volts	**Right Answer: A** Where the environment is damp, or restricting and conductive, the magnitude of any electric shock will be higher than under normal conditions. Hand lamps in such locations should therefore be supplied from a SELV (separated extra-low voltage) system, i.e. having a maximum voltage of 50 volts and which is electrically separated from earth.
B.	110 volts	
C.	230 volts	
D.	400 volts	

QUESTION 8.19		
If you only have a mains voltage (230 V) hand drill and you want to use it on a construction site which only has yellow (110 V) socket-outlets, what should you do?		
A.	Use a transformer to boost the voltage	**Right Answer: C** Electrical equipment must not be modified or operated at voltages other than their design voltage.
B.	Cut the plug off and fit a yellow one instead	
C.	Obtain a 110 V drill or a cordless one for the work	
D.	Make up an extension cable with a yellow plug on one end and a standard socket on the other end	

QUESTION 8.20		
What is most commonly used to reduce 230 volts to 110 volts on site?		
A.	Residual current device	**Right Answer: B** A transformer, usually coloured yellow, will transform 230 volts (mains voltage) down to a relatively safe 110 volts.
B.	Transformer	
C.	Circuit breaker	
D.	Step-down generator	

QUESTION 8.21		
When using an extension cable reel, which of the following statements is correct?		
A.	Leave as much as possible coiled up on the reel	**Right Answer: C** The rating of a partially unreeled extension cable is much lower than when fully unreeled. Overheating of the cable will occur if the rating is exceeded. Care should also be taken to prevent extension cables becoming a tripping hazard.
B.	Uncoil it fully every time	
C.	Do not exceed the reeled or unreeled rating as appropriate	
D.	Only uncoil what you need	

QUESTION 8.22		
If an extension cable is to be run across a site road, what action should you take?		
A.	Throw wooden boards over it	**Right Answer: B** It is essential that the cable is protected from damage caused by passing traffic. A sign will warn road traffic of the ramp.
B.	Place a rubber protection ramp over it and put up a sign stating 'Ramp Ahead'	
C.	Don' t do anything to protect the cable	
D.	Lay the cable over wooden boards	

QUESTION 8.23		
To operate a powered hand tool you must be:		
A.	16 years old or over	**Right Answer: D** There are no general age restrictions in legislation relating to the use of work equipment. Any person using work equipment. however, must be competent to do so, which will require initial and refresher training.
B.	18 years old or over	
C.	21 years old or over	
D.	Trained and competent	

QUESTION 8.24		
If you are about to use a power tool and discover the guard is missing, you should:		
A.	Make up a temporary guard yourself	**Right Answer: C** Visual checks should be carried out before using equipment. Any faults should be reported immediately and rectified before use.
B.	Use the tool but try to work quickly	
C.	Not use the tool until a proper guard has been fitted	
D.	Use the tool but work carefully and slowly	

SPECIAL SITE HAZARDS

QUESTION 9.1

Why may a confined space be dangerous to work in?

A.	There may not be sufficient working space	**Right Answer: D** There can be a range of hazards associated with confined spaces, and these can include all of those mentioned.
B.	Air in the space may be unbreathable due to poisonous gas	
C.	Temperature and poor ventilation may affect the worker	
D.	All of the hazards mentioned	

QUESTION 9.2

What must be considered first when planning to carry out work in a confined space?

A.	Has the job been priced properly	**Right Answer: D** Working outside will remove the risks of working in the confined space.
B.	Have the correct tools been arranged	
C.	Has sufficient manpower been allocated	
D.	Can the work be done from the outside	

QUESTION 9.3

When working in a confined space, such as a sewer, what danger may occur?

A.	Getting wet through	**Right Answer: D** Sewer gases can be inflammable and suffocating.
B.	Boredom	
C.	Not enough time for the job to be done	
D.	Build-up of harmful gases	

QUESTION 9.4

To determine the safety of the atmosphere in an excavation, which of the following is essential.

A.	Sniffing the atmosphere after entry	**Right Answer: B** Use a suitable detector. Many dangerous gases have no smell and cannot be seen. Workers can be overcome in seconds in dangerous atmospheres.
B.	Using a gas detector	
C.	Only entering for a short period to enable a quick escape	
D.	Looking for toxic gases	

QUESTION 9.5

Before entering an excavation to start work, it must first be:

A.	Inspected by a competent person	**Right Answer: A** Excavation work is hazardous. A competent person, knowledgeable about how to reduce risks, notably from collapse of the walls, must inspect the excavation first.
B.	Covered over and left overnight	
C.	Filled with water then drained	
D.	Inspected by the HSE	

QUESTION 9.6

What is the purpose of using a 'permit to work' system?

A.	To ensure the job is carried out by the quickest method	**Right Answer: B** A permit to work is a written system used to control certain types of hazardous work. They allow work to start only when site procedures have been clarified.
B.	To help ensure a safe system of work	
C.	To ensure that the client will pay for the work	
D.	To enable tools and equipment to be properly checked before the commencement of work	

QUESTION 9.7		
Why may young people be more at risk on site?		
A.	There is no specific legislation applying to them	**Right Answer: D** Health and Safety guidance lists young people as often being 'at particular risk', due to their lack of practical experience.
B.	They are usually left to work alone to gain experience	
C.	There is no requirement to provide PPE to young people	
D.	They are inexperienced and may not recognise danger	

QUESTION 9.8		
You have to enter a manhole in which you know there are toxic gases. You have all the PPE but there does not appear to be a rescue plan in place. What should you do?		
A.	Just get on and do the job, it will probably be alright	**Right Answer: C** A rescue plan must be in place before anyone enters a confined space. This is one of the requirements of the Confined Spaces Regulations 1997.
B.	Plan to carry out the job in short bursts	
C.	Do not enter the manhole until a rescue plan and rescue equipment are in place	
D.	Ask your mate to stand-by at the top of the manhole with a length of rope	

QUESTION 9.9		
You have to enter a manhole in which you believe there could be toxic gases. You have not been provided with any Respiratory Protective Equipment (RPE). What should you do?		
A.	Tell your supervisor that you will need RPE, and if necessary, training in confined space working	**Right Answer: A** An employer must provide all necessary personal protective equipment and respiratory protective equipment when an employee is required to enter a confined space. This is one of the requirements of the Confined Spaces Regulations 1997.
B.	Sniff the atmosphere in the manhole to see if you can smell harmful gases	
C.	Look into the manhole to see if you can see any harmful gases	
D.	Just get on with the job, and accept the risks	

QUESTION 9.10		
While digging a trench, you uncover a length of yellow marker tape at a depth of about 150mm. What does the presence of the marker tape mean?		
A.	The area has a high water-table and precautions must be taken to prevent an in-rush of water	**Right Answer: B** The coloured tape indicates that there are buried services below the route of the tape.
B.	There is a buried electrical cable and further excavation must be carried out with care	
C.	There is contaminated soil below the level of the marker tape and all excavation must stop	
D.	The excavation has reached a depth where the sides must now be supported	

QUESTION 9.11		
A Cable Avoidance Tool (C.A.T.) and a 'Genny' (generator) can be used successfully to locate underground cables by whom:		
A.	Anyone	**Right Answer: B** Equipment used to locate buried services must only be used by people who have been trained to use it.
B.	A competent person after training	
C.	Any electricity company employee	
D.	The site foreman	

QUESTION 9.12		
When exposing underground power cables, which method of excavation should you use?		
A.	A 360 degree excavator with rubber tyres	**Right Answer: C** Hand-held power tools and mechanical excavators should not be used too close to underground services and hand digging should be carried out with care.
B.	A pickaxe	
C.	Hand digging	
D.	A kango hammer	

QUESTION 9.13		
When do special precautions need to be taken when working near overhead electric power lines?		
A.	Only if cranes etc. are being used	**Right Answer: D** Actual contact with a power line is not necessary to result in an electric shock as a close approach may allow 'flashover' to occur. HSE publication GS6 gives advice on procedures to avoid such danger.
B.	Only if someone could touch a line with their bare hands	
C.	Only if plant has to pass under the lines	
D.	Whenever work areas will be near or beneath the lines	

QUESTION 9.14		
When working alone:		
A.	Make sure someone responsible knows where you are	**Right Answer: A** Employees should adhere to safe working arrangements put in place by their employer. When working alone, such arrangements should include informing a responsible person of your location periodically.
B.	You can do away with protective equipment	
C.	Don't bother anyone if you have a problem, always sort it out yourself	
D.	Wear headphones, it will make the day go more quickly	

QUESTION 9.15		
You have to walk across a site several times a day, but have to dodge a lot of site traffic. The first thing you should do is:		
A.	Have word with the drivers	**Right Answer: C** Pedestrian routes should have been set up to keep people and vehicles apart, so inform your employer if the system is not working. Don't hitch rides on vehicles unless safe seating is provided.
B.	Walk around the edges of the site to keep out of the way	
C.	Tell your supervisor about the danger	
D.	Jump on the back of a vehicle if you can, it's safer than walking	

QUESTION 9.16		
A mobile plant operator can let you ride in the machine:		
A.	If you have a long way to go	**Right Answer: C** Don't hitch rides on vehicles unless safe seating is provided.
B.	If it is raining	
C.	If it is designed to carry passengers	
D.	At any time	

QUESTION 10.1		
In accordance with the Electricity at Work regulations, when considering whether to work live a responsible person should:		
A.	Carry out a risk assessment	**Right Answer: A** To identify and assess the risks involved and the methods of controlling them.
B.	Only work dead	
C.	Only work live	
D.	Do as the client demands	

QUESTION 10.2		
The normal procedure for working on electrical equipment should be which one of the following?		
A.	Dead working	**Right Answer: A** Dead working should be considered as the norm and work on or near live conductors should rarely be permitted.
B.	Wearing insulated gloves	
C.	Using insulated tools	
D.	Live working	

QUESTION 10.3		
Test instruments used for working on electrical systems should:		
A.	Be yellow in colour	**Right Answer: D** To protect the user from electric shock whilst using the instrument. i.e. handling the probes.
B.	Be less than 10 years old	
C.	Have non-insulated test probes	
D.	Have insulated test probes	

QUESTION 10.4		
Under the Electricity at Work Regulations, live working is considered:		
A.	As entirely acceptable	**Right Answer: C** Extra controls must be employed, including training, supervision and use of suitable tools and protective equipment.
B.	To be normally permitted	
C.	Only to be allowed in exceptional circumstances	
D.	Never to be allowed	

QUESTION 10.5		
Which of the following would you use to replace the fuse in a plug if fuses were NOT available?		
A.	A nail	**Right Answer: D** A fuse is often the main safety device in an electrical circuit. A blown fuse must only be replaced by a fuse of the correct type and rating.
B.	A piece of silver paper	
C.	A bit of wire	
D.	None of the options listed	

QUESTION 10.6		
To prove a circuit or equipment is dead after isolation what is the FIRST activity in the sequence of events?		
A.	Make sure equipment is not working	**Right Answer: C** This will prove that that the voltage detector (such as a two-pole voltage detector or proprietary test lamp) is working, i.e. indicating voltage.
B.	Check between line and earth	
C.	Check that the voltage detector is working on a proving device, known live source or in built test feature	
D.	Check between line and neutral	

QUESTION 10.7		
The nominal single phase voltage in the UK is?		
A.	230 volts	**Right Answer: A** This is the nominal voltage for public electricity supply systems within Europe.
B.	240 volts	
C.	415 volts	
D.	400 volts	

QUESTION 10.8		
When is live working permissible?		
A.	When the person carrying out the work is a competent person	**Right Answer: B** This is a requirement under r.14 of the EAW Regulations. However, it does not mean that live working is then 'safe'.
B.	When it is unreasonable in all circumstances for the equipment to be made dead and suitable precautions are taken	
C.	When the means of isolation cannot be identified	
D.	When the person working on the equipment is wearing rubber gloves	

QUESTION 10.9		
Which of the following is NOT a requirement of low voltage safe isolation practice?		
A.	Ensuring that the correct point of isolation is identified	**Right Answer: B** Safe isolation practice refers to dead working. The use of insulating gloves will generally only be applicable to live working.
B.	The person carrying out the work is issued with insulating gloves	
C.	A caution notice should be applied at the point of isolation	
D.	The conductors are proved to be dead at the point of work	

QUESTION 10.10		
The specific effects on the human body of a major electric shock are one of the following:		
A.	Dermatitis	**Right Answer: B**
B.	Burns and cardiac arrest	
C.	Broken bones	
D.	Chest pains	

QUESTION 10.11		
The lowest level of electrical current which can harm the human body is normally measured in:		
A.	Microamps	**Right Answer: D** Research has shown that a person is in serious danger of a fatal electric shock at. or above, approximately 30 milliamps.
B.	Kiloamps	
C.	Amps	
D.	Milliamps	

QUESTION 10.12		
With regard to the effect of electrical current on the human body, one of the following is correct:		
A.	A 6 amp circuit breaker should prevent a person receiving a fatal electric shock	**Right Answer: C** An RCD is a mechanical switching device intended to cause the opening of the contacts when the residual current attains a given value under specified conditions.
B.	A 3 amp fuse should prevent a person receiving a fatal electric shock	
C.	A 30 mA Residual Current Device (RCD) should prevent a person receiving a fatal electric shock	
D.	A 5 amp rewireable fuse should prevent a person receiving a fatal electric shock	

QUESTION 10.13		
Where mains voltage is used to supply portable equipment on a construction site, what additional protection is required?		
A.	Step-down transformer	**Right Answer: D** Reduced low voltage systems (e.g. 110 volt centre point earthed) are strongly preferred in such circumstances. Where only mains voltage (230 V) equipment is available, however, a 30 mA RCD will give additional protection against fatal electric shock.
B.	Step-down generator	
C.	Cable avoidance tool	
D.	Residual current device (RCD)	

QUESTION 10.14		
What colour cable USUALLY signifies 110 volt power supply on site?		
A.	Black	**Right Answer: D** Yellow is the usual colour of cables, socket outlets, plugs and transformers etc which are used with a 110 volt supply.
B.	Red	
C.	Blue	
D.	Yellow	

QUESTION 10.15		
A portable electric generator on site has two power outlets, 110 volts and 230 volts. What colour would the 110 volt outlet be?		
A.	Black	**Right Answer: B** Yellow is the usual colour of cables, socket outlets, plugs and transformers etc which are used with a 110 volt supply.
B.	Yellow	
C.	Red	
D.	Blue	

QUESTION 10.16		
Where there is no local means of isolation for equipment or circuits to be worked on, which of the following is the preferred method of isolation?		
A.	Use a suitable device such as a circuit breaker	**Right Answer: A** Isolating the whole installation or distribution board is the safest method.
B.	Isolation of the individual circuit breaker or fuse	
C.	Pulling out the distributor's cut-out fuse	
D.	Disconnecting the individual circuit from the DB	

QUESTION 10.17		
What action should you take if a workmate gets an electric shock?		
A.	Phone the electricity board immediately	**Right Answer: C** If you can switch the power off, the electric hazard will be removed. First aid assistance will then probably be required. Do not touch someone who is still in contact with live electrical cables as you could also receive an electric shock.
B.	Dial 999 and ask for the fire brigade	
C.	Cut off the power and call for help	
D.	Try to pull them to safety	

QUESTION 10.18		
A residual current device is designed to operate in the event of one of the following:		
A.	Overload	**Right Answer: B** An RCD provides additional protection against the risk of electric shock.
B.	Earth fault	
C.	Lightning strike on the supply	
D.	Short-circuit	

QUESTION 10.19		
Electrical installations on construction sites should be periodically inspected and tested:		
A.	Every 3 months	**Right Answer: A** Three monthly inspections of construction site installations are recommended in IET Guidance Note 3.
B.	Every year	
C.	Every 6 months	
D.	Every month	

QUESTION 10.20		
The maximum AC voltage which the human body can withstand without long term physiological effects in dry conditions is:		
A.	110 volts	**Right Answer: C** Regarded as a non-fatal voltage level.
B.	230 volts	
C.	50 volts	
D.	400 volts	

QUESTION 10.21		
Which of the following statements is true with regard to the dangers of electricity?		
A.	Electricity is perfectly safe so long as you wear cotton gloves	**Right Answer: D** The features which make electricity so dangerous are that you cannot see, hear or smell it. It can give you a very unpleasant surprise. Always assume that cables are live.
B.	Electricity is only dangerous if you are not wearing wellington boots	
C.	Electricity is only dangerous in wet weather	
D.	Electricity is dangerous at any time because you cannot tell by looking at a cable whether or not it is live	

QUESTION 10.22		
What is the most serious effect that electric shock can have if you come into contact with a live part?		
A.	The electric current can cause a slight tingling in the fingers	**Right Answer: C** Contact with live electrical parts can be fatal. If you do not know otherwise, always assume that electrical parts are live.
B.	The electric current can cause burn marks on the fingers	
C.	The electric current can cause the heart to stop, resulting in death	
D.	The electric current can cause the finger muscles to twitch	

QUESTION 10.23		
Your job involves you working near to hanging electrical cables which have bare ends. What should you do?		
A.	Touch the cables to see if they are live	**Right Answer: C** You must always assume that exposed cables are live until you know they are not. Contact with live electrical cables can kill.
B.	Carry on working, as there shouldn't be a problem	
C.	Inform your supervisor and keep well away	
D.	Attempt to push the cables back into the ceiling void so that you can start work	

QUESTION 10.24		
For all live working activities it is necessary to:		
A.	Carry out a risk assessment as required by the EAW Regulations.	**Right Answer: A**
B.	Wear rubber gloves only	
C.	Be accompanied	
D.	Keep your fingers crossed	

QUESTION 10.25		
An electrical Permit to Work is primarily a statement that:		
A.	Someone else has taken responsibility for the work	**Right Answer: D** Permits to work describe the procedures that prevent a major hazard, such as electricity or moving machinery, from causing harm, usually by isolation to effectively ensure (in the case of electricity) 'dead' working with no chance of it going 'live' .
B.	The circuit or equipment is live	
C.	Certain instructions need to be followed	
D.	The circuit or equipment has been isolated and is safe to work on	

QUESTION 10.26		
The probes of voltage detectors and test instruments used on electrical systems should be:		
A.	Manufactured in the UK	**Right Answer: C** In addition, to protect against damage by overcurrent whilst in use, the probes or instrument should incorporate suitable high breaking capacity (hbc) fuses with a low current rating (usually not exceeding 500 mA). or current-limiting resistors.
B.	Accompanied by a calibration certificate	
C.	Shaped or have barriers to prevent finger contact with the tips	
D.	Coloured red	

QUESTION 10.27		
Which of the following does the Electricity at Work (EAW) regulations apply to?		
A.	All persons engaged for work purposes	**Right Answer: A** The EAW Regulations impose duties on employers, employees and the self employed.
B.	Self employed persons only	
C.	Employees only	
D.	Employers only	

QUESTION 10.28		
The Electricity at Work Regulations require that:		
A.	Persons working with electricity must have the appropriate level of knowledge and experience	**Right Answer: A** Competency is a requirement of r.16 of the EAW Regulations.
B.	A training course is necessary before anyone can work with electricity	
C.	Only electricians can work with electricity	
D.	Anyone supervised can work with electricity	

QUESTION 10.29		
The Electricity at Work Regulations apply to:		
A.	Only low voltage systems	**Right Answer: C** The EAW Regulations cover the safe use of electricity in work activities, irrespective of voltage.
B.	Only extra-low voltage systems	
C.	All voltage systems	
D.	Only high voltage systems	

QUESTION 10.30		
Which of the following should be used to prove a circuit or equipment is dead after isolation?		
A.	A lamp holder with a length of flex attached	**Right Answer: B** Accident history has shown that using incorrectly set multimeters or makeshift devices for voltage detection has often caused accidents. The use of non-contact voltage indicators (voltage sticks) is also not advised as the sole means of proving dead.
B.	A proprietary test lamp or two-pole voltage detector	
C.	A voltage stick	
D.	A multimeter	

QUESTION 10.31		
Which of the following is NOT a suitable means of isolating a circuit?		
A.	Removing a fuse and locking the distribution board	**Right Answer: B** The isolating device should be switched off or the fuse removed. The switch, circuit breaker or enclosure should then be locked and the key removed. A notice or label should also be posted to warn that someone is working on the circuit or apparatus.
B.	Putting insulating tape over the circuit breaker	
C.	Padlocking the isolating switch	
D.	Fitting a padlocked circuit breaker lockout	

QUESTION 10.32

Which of the following work procedures on electrical systems will **always** require a permit-to-work to be issued?

A.	Dead working on low-voltage systems	**Right Answer: C** An electrical permit-to-work should state what circuit or equipment has been made safe, how that has been achieved and what work is to be done. A permit should not, therefore, be used for live working. Such a permit is always required for work on high-voltage systems, but can also be used for low-voltage systems.
B.	Live working on low-voltage systems	
C.	Dead working on high-voltage systems	
D.	Live working on high-voltage systems	

QUESTION 10.33

Optical fibre cable remnants should not be left lying around on site because:

A.	They can be hot and burn upon contact	**Right Answer: C** Fibre fragments can enter the bloodstream and cause infections in the skin or eyes. All fibre waste, particularly small pieces, should be placed in suitable receptacles.
B.	Laser beams still exist in the cut pieces	
C.	They can pierce the skin or eyes	
D.	They are toxic	

QUESTION 10.34

Why should the end of an optical fibre cable never be pointed towards your own or anyone else's eyes?

A.	The beam can transfer a strong electric current	**Right Answer: D** Exposure to light sources such as lasers or highly concentrated visible or infrared light beams, associated with the testing or use of optical fibres, can cause damage to the eyes, or even blindness.
B.	The colour of the beam is very hypnotic	
C.	The beam can bore a hole through the skin	
D.	The beam can damage the eyes	

QUESTION 10.35

The use of a multi-lock hasp with the appropriate number of padlocks is a recommended method of safe isolation where:

A.	Individual circuit breaker locking off devices are not available	**Right Answer: C** A multi-lock hasp can be used to prevent operation of the isolator until such time that all persons working on the electrical installation have completed their work and removed their padlocks from the hasp.
B.	Individual circuit breakers are not identified at the distribution board	
C.	More than one person will be working on circuits supplied from the same distribution board	
D.	You know the health and safety inspector is in the area	

QUESTION 10.36

Which of the following procedures should be used when more than one person will be working on circuits supplied from a distribution board which has been switched off?

A.	The use of a multi-lock hasp on the isolator with a padlock for each operative	**Right Answer: A** A multi-lock hasp can be used to prevent operation of the isolator until such time that all persons working on the electrical installation have completed their work and removed their padlocks from the hasp.
B.	Blowing a horn before the power is switched on again	
C.	Giving each operative a volt stick	
D.	Telling everyone what time the power will be switched on again	

ENVIRONMENTAL

QUESTION 11.1

You are on site and you need to dispose of some waste liquid which has oil in it and you are not sure what to do with it. What should you do?

A.	Dispose of it in a sealed container into the site skip	**Right Answer: D** Dealing with hazardous/special waste will include proper storage and segregation before it is taken away by an authorised waste carrier as required by environmental legislation. An oil spillage could also get into the ground or drains, which may also be an offence under environmental law. Burning waste on site is also an offence, under air pollution legislation, and can lead to local complaints.
B.	Pour it onto the ground, it will soak away	
C.	Take it outside and set light to it	
D.	Ask your supervisor about the correct way to deal with this waste.	

QUESTION 11.2

How should you get rid of hazardous/special waste?

A.	Put it at the bottom of any site skip	**Right Answer: B** The Hazardous Waste Regulations (Special Waste Regulations in Scotland) require hazardous/special waste to be properly segregated or otherwise treated, and then recovered or disposed of in an officially approved way.
B.	In accordance with the correct site waste rules	
C.	Take it home, they wont want it on site	
D.	Take it to the nearest local authority waste tip	

QUESTION 11.3

Which of the following is classed as hazardous/special waste?

A.	Non-asbestos Insulation	**Right Answer: D** Hazardous wastes (special wastes in Scotland) are specified in waste legislation. Fluorescent tubes are included because of their mercury content.
B.	Polythene and shrink wrap	
C.	Empty cement bags	
D.	Fluorescent light tubes	

QUESTION 11.4

Which of the following should be disposed of as hazardous/special waste?

A.	Timber, plywood and MDF off-cuts	**Right Answer: C** Hazardous wastes (special wastes in Scotland) are specified in waste legislation. Aerosol sealants are included because they can explode if not recovered or disposed of properly, and they may still contain hazardous solvents.
B.	Glass fibre insulation	
C.	Aerosol sealant canisters	
D.	Used nuisance dust masks	

QUESTION 11.5

You need to clean up some oil that has leaked from machinery onto the ground. What is the right way to do this?

A.	Put the oily contaminated soil into the general waste skip	**Right Answer: B** Oil-contaminated wastes are classified as hazardous/special waste in waste legislation. The Hazardous Waste Regulations (Special Waste Regulations in Scotland) require such waste to be properly segregated or otherwise treated, and then recovered or disposed of in an approved way. Following the other options would be an offence under waste legislation.
B.	Put the oily contaminated soil into a suitable container that takes hazardous waste	
C.	Put it under some off-cuts so that the oil cannot be seen	
D.	Wash the oil away with water and detergent	

QUESTION 11.6		
Other site workers are complaining that you are generating too much dust. What should you do?		
A.	Tell them you have nearly finished	**Right Answer: B** Excessive dust may be a health hazard to you and those around you, but even if it is not a health hazard, excessive dust can be a 'statutory nuisance (under the Environmental Protection Act). Even when it is not a statutory nuisance, it can lead to complaints from neighbours and possible damage to neighbouring property.
B.	Stop work and inform your supervisor	
C.	Ignore them – it's none of their business	
D.	Issue the other site workers with dust masks	

QUESTION 11.7		
Who needs to understand relevant environmental risks on a construction site?		
A.	Only the principal contractor	**Right Answer: C** The actions of everyone on site determine how well the risks to the environment (such as water pollution, or creating a local nuisance) are controlled.
B.	Only the subcontractors	
C.	Everyone working on the site	
D.	Only the environmental clerk of works	

QUESTION 11.8		
Under environmental law, which statement is true?		
A.	Companies and individuals can be prosecuted if they do not follow the law	**Right Answer: A** Most environmental law is enforced against companies, but the regulator in the relevant part of the UK (the Environment Agency, SEPA or NIEA) can also prosecute company officers and even have powers to prosecute employees if they wilfully contribute to environmental harm.
B.	Companies can be prosecuted, but not individuals	
C.	It is legal to transport business waste without proper paperwork	
D.	It is legal to disturb protected species' habitats	

QUESTION 11.9		
Do individuals have any responsibility for sustainability when on site?		
A.	No, it is dealt with by the site manager	**Right Answer: D** Your responsibility is to follow the site and company rules aimed at environmental protection and sustainability, and to help your company to comply with relevant legal requirements, such as the need to segregate waste properly (e.g. so that it can be recovered).
B.	No, it is a matter for the Environment Agency/NIEA/SEPA	
C.	Only on sites where there is asbestos	
D.	Yes, on every site	

QUESTION 11.10		
Which of the following is NOT best practice from a sustainability point of view?		
A.	Saving materials, fuel, water and energy	**Right Answer: D** Option D would be wasting a valuable natural resource (copper) that could be effectively recovered for later use or recycling. Reusing or recycling copper has less environmental impact than mining and extracting new copper reserves.
B.	Looking after the people working on or near the site	
C.	Protecting the environment	
D.	Sending unused and waste copper cables to landfill	

QUESTION 11.11		
Which of the following does NOT help sustainability during construction projects?		
A.	Leaving engines and motors running when they are not needed	**Right Answer: A** Option A generates local air pollution and carbon dioxide emissions (which contribute to global warming), and also increases the noise nuisance.
B.	Segregating waste	
C.	Vehicle sharing or using public transport to get to work	
D.	Avoiding overheating site huts	

QUESTION 11.12		
Which of the following should you do on site in the interest of sustainability?		
A.	Run plant and equipment when they are not needed	**Right Answer: C** Your actions will help your company, and others working on site, to achieve more sustainable work practices, such as waste recovery.
B.	Bury waste material	
C.	Comply with site instructions on handling waste materials	
D.	Pour waste liquids down a drain off-site	

QUESTION 11.13		
Which of the following is NOT part of 'environmentally-friendly' construction?		
A.	Creating a dust nuisance to residents in neighbouring properties	**Right Answer: A** Neighbours outside the site are an important part of the wider environment. They may be affected by nuisance (such as noise, dust or even light at night), and they may complain to the client, main contractor or the local enforcing authority. Creating certain types of nuisance is an offence under the Environmental Protection Act.
B.	Preventing water and soil pollution	
C.	Saving energy	
D.	Minimising the amount of waste you create during a job	

QUESTION 11.14		
From an environmental point of view, why should materials be reused, where possible?		
A.	To save the client money	**Right Answer: B** Although reducing the amount of waste is the first priority, the re-use of materials can also contribute to effective waste management.
B.	A lot of energy and raw materials go into making most construction products	
C.	It makes less mess on site	
D.	Its' a European Union Law	

QUESTION 11.15		
Which action will help to minimise waste?		
A.	Only take or open what you need and return or reseal anything left over	**Right Answer: A** The hierarchy for managing waste is to reduce/reuse/recover. Reducing the amount of waste is therefore the first priority.
B.	Use new materials/packs at the beginning of each day	
C.	Leave materials unprotected in the rain	
D.	Always order much more than usually required – just in case you need it	

QUESTION 11.16		
Which of the following is good environmental practice?		
A.	Over-ordering materials	**Right Answer: B** This is good practice, since it will help with waste recovery. If the waste is classified as hazardous waste (special waste in Scotland) proper segregation is also a legal requirement.
B.	Segregating waste into different types	
C.	Leaving skips uncovered in wet weather	
D.	Leaving motors running when they are not needed	

QUESTION 11.17		
Do individuals have any responsibility for minimising the amount of waste created on site?		
A.	Only if asbestos removal is being carried out	**Right Answer: B** Your actions will help your company, and others on site, to procure sensibly and to organise the job so that materials and substances are not wasted. Waste reduction is the best option when trying to manage site waste.
B.	Yes, everyone on site has this responsibility	
C.	No, it's the responsibility of the client	
D.	Only during site clean-up, at the end of the project	

QUESTION 11.18		
If you have unused material left, what should you do before you consider putting non-hazardous waste items into a skip?		
A.	Make sure there is a label on it	**Right Answer: C** Although reducing the amount of waste is the first priority, the reuse of waste materials is much better than disposal, which is the most expensive option and which should be the last resort. Reuse is a better waste management option than recovery.
B.	Put it in a plastic bag and put it in a skip	
C.	Check whether someone else on your team can make use of it	
D.	Weigh it	

QUESTION 11.19		
Why should different types of waste be separated on site?		
A.	It will take up less room in the skip	**Right Answer: D** This is good practice, since waste recovery can save both energy and materials, compared to creating brand new materials or items. It will also cut the amount of waste that goes to landfill. If the waste is classed as hazardous (special waste in Scotland) then the effective separation of different wastes is a legal requirement.
B.	So the local council can charge Landfill Tax	
C.	So the main contractor can check what's being thrown away	
D.	So waste can be recovered more easily	

QUESTION 11.20		
When storing liquids (such as oils, fuels or chemicals) on-site, what must you do?		
A.	Always use the nearest container	**Right Answer: C** Any spillage could get into the ground or drains, which is likely to be an offence under environmental legislation.
B.	Use a transparent container so you can check how much liquid is in it	
C.	Ensure the liquid material is stored safely and securely, and out of the way of site traffic	
D.	Keep the tops off, to prevent pressure from building up	

QUESTION 11.21		
What can help to prevent harm to the environment from oil spillages?		
A.	A supply of water to flush the spill away	**Right Answer: D** The use of a bund (fully walled storage area) or a drip tray will help any spillage to be contained in a small area for clear up. Any spillage could get into the ground or drains, which is likely to be an offence under environmental legislation.
B.	Cover the spillage with soil	
C.	Turning liquid containers upside down so the top can't come off	
D.	Store oils in an area that can catch any spills, such as a bund or a drip tray.	

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